

ShopEase Customer Support Knowledge Base

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Classification: Enterprise Internal & AI RAG Knowledge Base

Target Audience: AI Customer Support Systems, Human Support Specialists, Operations Lead Teams

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Notice of Confidentiality and AI Operational Guidelines:

This document serves as the operational baseline for ShopEase customer support workflows and vectorized knowledge retrieval systems. Information contained herein is subject to real-time sync with backend microservices.

Document Version History

Version	Release Date	Author / Team	Summary of Changes
1.0.0	January 15, 2023	Core Docs Team	Initial release for ShopEase Global Operations.
2.0.0	November 10, 2023	Knowledge Engineering	Integrated Marketplace Seller Center workflows and EMI policies.
3.0.0	June 05, 2024	AI Integration Unit	RAG-optimization pass: removed relative citations, added explicit context blocks.
4.0.0	January 12, 2025	Operations Lead	Updated international shipping tiers and expanded Prime delivery SLAs.
4.2.0	February 01, 2026	Global Customer Care	Comprehensive expansion: added explicit troubleshooting matrices and 100+ FAQ nodes.

Preface & RAG Architecture Context

This document is engineered to act as both a human-readable operational handbook and an indexed knowledge base optimized for Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG) models.

Chunking & Retrieval Protocols

1. **Self-Contained Content Nodes:** Every section, subsection, and troubleshooting scenario contains full contextual anchors. Relative directional references (e.g., "as stated above," "refer to the previous chapter") are omitted.
2. **Explicit Heading Hierarchy:** Markdown headers (#, ##, ###) are paired with descriptive terms to preserve semantic context when chunked into vector embeddings (stored in FAISS index stores).
3. **Keyword Density:** Product categories, account types, payment identifiers, and status codes are explicitly stated in every procedure.

Table of Contents

- **Chapter 1: Company Overview**
 - Introduction
 - Purpose
 - Definitions
 - Policies
 - Rules
 - Eligibility
 - Step-by-Step Procedures
 - Examples
 - Real Customer Scenarios
 - Important Notes
 - Warnings
 - Best Practices
 - Frequently Asked Questions
 - Troubleshooting
 - Summary
- **Chapter 2: Account Management**
 - Introduction

- Purpose
- Definitions
- Policies
- Rules
- Eligibility
- Step-by-Step Procedures
- Examples
- Real Customer Scenarios
- Important Notes
- Warnings
- Best Practices
- Frequently Asked Questions
- Troubleshooting
- Summary

- **Chapter 3: Login & Security**

- Introduction
- Purpose
- Definitions
- Policies
- Rules
- Eligibility
- Step-by-Step Procedures
- Examples
- Real Customer Scenarios
- Important Notes
- Warnings
- Best Practices
- Frequently Asked Questions

- Troubleshooting
 - Summary
- **Chapter 4: Order Management**
- **Chapter 5: Shipping & Delivery**
- **Chapter 6: Returns & Refunds**
- **Chapter 7: Payments & Billing**
- **Chapter 8: Prime Membership**
- **Chapter 9: Gift Cards & Promotions**
- **Chapter 10: Seller Center**
- **Chapter 11: Privacy & Security Policy**
- **Chapter 12: Frequently Asked Questions**
- **Chapter 13: Troubleshooting Guide**
- **Chapter 14: Customer Support Process**
- **Chapter 15: Glossary**

Chapter 1: Company Overview

Introduction

ShopEase is a global multi-category e-commerce platform designed to deliver seamless shopping experiences across consumer goods, digital products, and merchant services. Taglined "*Your Trusted Online Shopping Destination*," ShopEase connects millions of retail customers with verified direct suppliers and third-party marketplace sellers.

Purpose

The purpose of this chapter is to outline the operational scope, core values, organizational structure, service-level commitments, and fundamental customer touchpoints across the ShopEase e-commerce ecosystem.

Definitions

- **ShopEase Ecosystem:** The combined web platform ([www.shopease.com](<https://www.shopease.com>)), native iOS/Android applications, merchant dashboard (ShopEase Seller Center), and API infrastructure.
- **Direct Retail:** Products sold directly by ShopEase, inventoried in ShopEase Fulfillment Centers (FC), and fulfilled via internal logistical networks.

- **Marketplace Seller:** Third-party merchant authorized to list and sell items on the ShopEase platform.
- **Customer Care Touchpoint:** Any automated (AI Assistant) or human interaction channel (Voice, Chat, Email) provided by ShopEase.

Policies

ShopEase Core Service Level Agreement (SLA)

ShopEase operates a 24/7/365 customer support infrastructure. Platform uptime commitments, order processing guarantees, and response SLAs are outlined in the table below.

Service Channel	Operating Hours	Target First Response Time	Escalation SLA
AI Virtual Assistant	24/7/365	Immediate (< 2 seconds)	Instant Hand-off
Live Chat Support	24/7/365	< 45 seconds	15 Minutes
Email Support	24/7/365	< 4 Hours	12 Hours
Voice Support	06:00 - 22:00 EST	< 2 Minutes	30 Minutes

Product Category Coverage Policy

ShopEase officially inventories, categorizes, and provides customer support for ten distinct retail verticals:

1. **Electronics:** Laptops, smartphones, audio devices, smart home setups, wearables.
2. **Fashion:** Apparel, footwear, accessories, eyewear, luggage.
3. **Home & Kitchen:** Appliances, cookware, bedding, home decor, bath accessories.
4. **Grocery:** Non-perishable foods, beverages, household supplies, fresh produce (select regions).
5. **Books:** Physical print books, e-books, audiobooks, educational materials.
6. **Beauty:** Skincare, cosmetics, haircare, fragrances, personal grooming appliances.
7. **Sports:** Fitness equipment, athletic apparel, outdoor gear, team sports supplies.
8. **Toys:** Action figures, board games, educational sets, outdoor play equipment.
9. **Furniture:** Office furniture, living room sets, bedroom frames, outdoor seating.
10. **Automotive Accessories:** Car electronics, maintenance tools, seat covers, replacement parts.

Rules

Platform Usage Guidelines

1. Users must maintain a single, verified customer account tied to a valid email address and phone number.
2. Automated scraping, unauthorized transactional bots, or artificial price manipulating tools are strictly prohibited on the ShopEase platform.
3. Customer interactions with ShopEase support staff and marketplace sellers must adhere to the ShopEase Anti-Harassment Policy. Profanity, abusive language, and fraudulent claims result in immediate account suspension.

Eligibility

Account Creation Eligibility

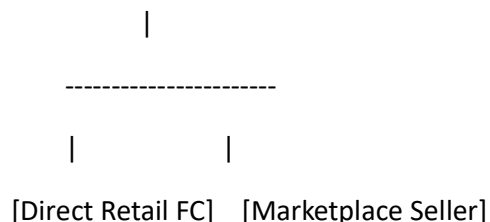
- To create a ShopEase customer account, individuals must be at least 18 years of age or the legal age of majority in their jurisdiction.
- Minors between the ages of 13 and 17 may use ShopEase services exclusively under the direct supervision of a parent or legal guardian who registers the account.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Verify Company Authenticity and Official Channels

1. **Verify Web URL:** Ensure the browser URL matches https://www.shopease.com or official country-specific subdomains (e.g., https://uk.shopease.com).
2. **Verify Mobile App:** Download the official ShopEase app only from the Apple App Store or Google Play Store. Verify the publisher name is **ShopEase Commerce Technologies Inc.**
3. **Verify Email Communications:** All official transactional emails from ShopEase are dispatched exclusively from domains ending in @shopease.com or @notifications.shopease.com.

[Customer Browser/App] <---> [TLS 1.3 Encryption] <---> [ShopEase Gateway]



Examples

Official vs Unofficial Channel Identification Example

- **Official Communication:** An email from order-update@notifications.shopease.com referencing an exact 12-digit Order ID (#SE-987654321012) with a link leading to https://www.shopease.com/orders.
- **Phishing/Unofficial Attempt:** An SMS from an unverified shortcode asking the user to click a link like shopease-tracking-update.com to pay a custom fee. **ShopEase never requests payments via external URL shorteners.**

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 1: Customer Inquiring About Regional Service Availability

- **Context:** A customer located in a remote postal code wants to know if ShopEase delivers fresh groceries and large furniture items to their area.
- **Resolution Workflow:** Support agent inputs the postal code into the *ShopEase Logistics Availability Checker*. The tool indicates standard freight delivery is available for large furniture, but fresh grocery delivery is outside the cold-chain radius. Agent informs the customer of furniture availability and provides an alternative non-perishable grocery option.

Important Notes

Note: ShopEase Direct Retail items and Third-Party Marketplace items can be placed in the same shopping cart and checked out in a single transaction. However, they may ship in separate packages from different fulfillment centers and carry distinct delivery timelines.

Warnings

Warning: ShopEase customer support representatives will **NEVER** ask for your account password, full credit card numbers, CVV codes, or One-Time Passwords (OTP). Do not share these credentials with anyone claiming to represent ShopEase.

Best Practices

- **Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** Protect your ShopEase account by enabling SMS or Authenticator App verification under Account Settings.
- **Keep Contact Information Updated:** Ensure your phone number and email address are current to receive real-time delivery notifications and security alerts.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 1.1: What is ShopEase?

Question: What is ShopEase and what services does it offer?

Answer: ShopEase is a global online shopping destination offering products across ten retail categories, including Electronics, Fashion, Home & Kitchen, Grocery, Books, Beauty, Sports, Toys, Furniture, and Automotive Accessories. Services include Prime Membership, Same-Day Delivery, Express/Standard Shipping, Easy Returns, Product Replacements, EMI Payments, ShopEase Wallet, Gift Cards, and a Marketplace for third-party sellers.

FAQ 1.2: How do I contact ShopEase Customer Support?

Question: What are the ways to contact ShopEase Customer Support?

Answer: You can reach ShopEase Customer Support 24/7 through Live Chat on the ShopEase mobile app or website, via email at support@shopease.com, or by calling phone support at 1-800-555-SHOPS (06:00 to 22:00 EST).

FAQ 1.3: Is my location supported for delivery?

Question: How do I know if ShopEase delivers to my address?

Answer: Enter your postal code at the top of the ShopEase home page or during the checkout process. The platform automatically calculates delivery eligibility, available shipping speeds, and fulfillment options for your exact address.

Troubleshooting

Problem 1.1: Web Page Fails to Load ShopEase Features

- **Possible Cause:** Stale browser cache, ad-blocker script interference, or outdated browser version.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Clear browser cookies and cache for *.shopease.com.
 2. Disable browser extensions related to ad-blocking or script modification for the ShopEase site.
 3. Ensure browser is updated to the latest version (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge).
 4. Access the site via an Incognito / Private window to test basic rendering.

Summary

ShopEase provides a comprehensive multi-category e-commerce engine operating with continuous customer support SLAs. Understanding official channels, security standards, and category availability ensures a safe and efficient customer experience.

Chapter 2: Account Management

Introduction

Account Management forms the foundation of the user experience on ShopEase. This chapter details profile creation, maintenance, address book management, communication preferences, account status modifications, and permanent deletion workflows.

Purpose

To establish clear operational protocols for managing customer accounts, ensuring account security, managing personal data, and maintaining accurate billing and shipping information.

Definitions

- **ShopEase Account:** A unique digital profile associated with a primary email address and phone number, holding order history, wallet funds, saved payment methods, and address books.
- **Primary Shipping Address:** The default physical location selected by the account holder for order dispatches.
- **Unverified Account:** An account created without completing email or SMS phone number validation.

Policies

Account Uniqueness Policy

Each customer may hold only one active primary ShopEase account. Duplicate accounts registered using secondary email addresses belonging to the same individual for abusing promotional codes or referral rewards are subject to consolidation or suspension under the ShopEase Terms of Service.

Data Retention Upon Deletion

When an account is permanently deleted upon customer request, active personal details are erased within 30 calendar days. Financial transactional records are retained in an encrypted archive for 7 years to comply with tax and audit regulations.

Rules

1. Profile names must reflect real personal or business identities. Impersonation of public figures, brands, or ShopEase personnel is strictly forbidden.
2. Address book entries must contain complete, accurate physical street details. PO Boxes are permitted for Standard Shipping only; Express and Same-Day delivery require physical street addresses.

Eligibility

- All registered ShopEase users with active accounts in good standing (no pending fraud investigations or negative balances) can edit their profile information at any time.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Update Profile Details and Email Address

1. Navigate to www.shopease.com and log in.
2. Click on **Account & Lists** in the top navigation bar.
3. Select **Login & Security**.
4. Click **Edit** next to the field you wish to update (e.g., Name, Email Address, Primary Mobile Phone).
5. Input the new information into the provided fields.
6. Enter your current password to authenticate the change.
7. Click **Save Changes**. A verification OTP (One-Time Password) will be sent to the new email address or phone number.
8. Enter the 6-digit OTP into the prompt to complete the update.

[User Request Edit] ---> [Enter Current Password] ---> [Dispatch OTP to New Email/Phone] ---> [Enter OTP] ---> [Database Update Success]

How to Add or Edit Shipping Addresses

1. Go to **Your Account > Your Addresses**.
2. To add a new address, click **Add Address**. To modify an existing address, click **Edit** beneath the saved address card.
3. Complete all required fields:
 - Full Name
 - Street Address, Apartment, Suite, Unit
 - City
 - State / Province / Region
 - Postal Code / Zip Code
 - Phone Number (for delivery coordination)
4. Check the box labeled **Set as Default Address** if desired.
5. Click **Save Address**.

How to Request Permanent Account Deletion

1. Log into your ShopEase account.
2. Navigate to **Your Account > Data & Privacy**.
3. Scroll to the bottom of the page and click **Close ShopEase Account**.
4. Read the mandatory disclosure outlining loss of Prime benefits, Wallet balances, and order history.
5. Select a reason for account closure from the drop-down menu.
6. Select the checkbox acknowledging that account deletion is permanent and irreversible.
7. Click **Confirm Account Closure**. A confirmation email will be sent to your primary address containing a final confirmation link. Click the link within 48 hours to complete the closure process.

Examples

Address Editing Impact Example

- **Scenario:** A customer updates their default address in **Your Addresses** *after* placing an order that is currently in "Preparing for Shipment" status.
- **Outcome:** Updating the address in **Your Addresses** changes the default for *future* orders only. To alter the delivery address for an existing order, the customer must navigate directly to **Your Orders**, select the specific order, and click **Change Shipping Address** (available only if the order has not entered the "Dispatched" state).

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 2.1: Customer Locked Out Due to Outdated Phone Number

- **Context:** Customer changed their mobile phone number and can no longer receive 2FA verification codes to access their ShopEase account.
- **Resolution Workflow:** Customer support verifies account ownership through identity verification protocols (verifying last 4 digits of payment card on file, historic order numbers, and billing zip code). Once verified, the agent manually triggers an email-based account recovery link allowing the customer to update their primary mobile phone number.

Important Notes

Note: Closing a ShopEase account automatically forfeits any non-refundable gift card balances, promotional credits, and remaining active time on a paid Prime Membership subscription.

Warnings

Warning: Never share account access credentials or multi-factor authentication codes with unverified third-party tools or price-tracking apps. Unauthorized access resulting from shared credentials may void account fraud protections.

Best Practices

- Keep at least two recovery contacts (a primary email and a verified mobile phone number) on file within your ShopEase profile settings.
- Review saved delivery addresses periodically and remove outdated residential or workplace addresses to prevent accidental misrouting during quick checkouts.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 2.1: How do I change my primary account email address?

Question: How can I change the email address linked to my ShopEase account?

Answer: Log in to your ShopEase account, go to **Your Account > Login & Security**, click **Edit** next to Email, type your new email address, enter your password, and verify the change using the OTP sent to your new email.

FAQ 2.2: Can I combine two separate ShopEase accounts into one?

Question: Is it possible to merge two ShopEase accounts into a single account?

Answer: Account merging is currently not supported. Order histories, Prime subscriptions, promotional credits, and ShopEase Wallet balances cannot be transferred between separate accounts. You must choose one primary account to retain.

FAQ 2.3: What happens to my pending orders if I delete my account?

Question: What occurs if I close my ShopEase account while I have orders in transit?

Answer: Account closure requests cannot be processed while there are active open orders, pending returns, or active dispute cases. All open transactions must be fully delivered, completed, or canceled before the system allows account deletion.

Troubleshooting

Problem 2.1: Updating Profile Details Results in Error Code AC-409

- **Possible Cause:** The new email address or phone number you are attempting to link is already associated with another active or suspended ShopEase account.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Verify if you previously created a ShopEase account using the target email or phone number.

2. If so, log into that secondary account and update its email/phone to a temporary value, or request deletion of the secondary account.
3. Return to your primary account and re-attempt the update process.
4. If the issue persists, contact Support with Error Code AC-409 for manual identity check and email dissociation.

Summary

Account management on ShopEase provides granular control over identity details, delivery locations, and privacy configurations. Keeping account data accurate ensures uninterrupted fulfillment and robust security.

Chapter 3: Login & Security

Introduction

ShopEase employs enterprise-grade authentication frameworks to shield user accounts from unauthorized access, credentials stuffing, and account takeover (ATO) threats. This chapter details authentication protocols, multi-factor settings, account lockouts, password restoration, and account recovery procedures.

Purpose

To outline security standards, password complexity policies, multi-factor authentication (2FA) setup instructions, and step-by-step procedures for resolving security locks and compromised credentials.

Definitions

- **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** An optional security layer requiring two separate forms of identification: a password and a secondary code (sent via SMS or generated by an Authenticator App).
- **Account Lockout:** A temporary suspension of access triggered by multiple consecutive failed login attempts or anomalous IP geographic jumps.
- **One-Time Password (OTP):** A time-sensitive, 6-digit numeric passcode generated for authentication events.

Policies

Password Policy Requirements

All ShopEase customer account passwords must strictly adhere to the following security criteria:

- Minimum length of **10 characters**; maximum length of **128 characters**.

- Must contain at least **one uppercase letter** (*A – Z*).
- Must contain at least **one lowercase letter** (*a – z*).
- Must contain at least **one numeric digit** (*0 – 9*).
- Must contain at least **one special character** (e.g., @, #, \$, %, !, &).
- Must not contain common dictionary words, sequential numbers (e.g., 123456), or the account holder's name/email string.

Fraud Protection & Suspicious Activity Policy

ShopEase security algorithms monitor login vectors in real time. If a login attempt originates from an unrecognized device or unusual IP subnet:

1. The user is prompted to complete a CAPTCHA and enter an OTP sent to their primary email address.
2. If three consecutive incorrect OTP attempts occur, the account is temporarily placed in **Security Hold** state for 2 hours.

Rules

1. Users are strictly prohibited from sharing login credentials across multiple individuals.
2. Password reuse across non-ShopEase services is strongly discouraged due to credential stuffing risks.

Eligibility

- Multi-Factor Authentication (2FA) is available to all registered ShopEase customer and seller accounts globally.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Set Up Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)

1. Log into your ShopEase account.
2. Select **Your Account > Login & Security**.
3. Click **Turn On** next to **Two-Step Verification (2SV) Settings**.
4. Choose your preferred authentication method:
 - **Authenticator App (Recommended)**: Scan the displayed QR Code using Google Authenticator, Authy, or 1Password. Enter the 6-digit code shown in the app.

- **SMS Verification:** Enter your mobile phone number. Enter the 6-digit code sent via text message.
5. Click **Verify and Continue**.
 6. Save your single-use **Backup Recovery Codes** in a safe physical or digital location. These allow access if you lose access to your primary 2FA device.

[Login Prompt] ---> [Validate Username/Password] ---> [Prompt 2FA Token] ---> [Validate 2FA Token] ---> [Grant Session Access]

How to Reset Your Forgotten Password

1. Navigate to the ShopEase login page and click **Forgot Password?**.
2. Enter the email address or phone number associated with your account and click **Continue**.
3. Check your email or mobile device for a 6-digit OTP code sent by ShopEase.
4. Input the 6-digit OTP on the verification screen.
5. Create a new password meeting all complexity criteria listed in the Password Policy.
6. Click **Save Changes and Log In**. All existing active web and app sessions on other devices will automatically be invalidated for security.

Examples

Security Lockout Event Example

- **Scenario:** A user attempts to log in six times in 2 minutes, entering an incorrect password each time.
- **Outcome:** System flags the activity as potential brute-force access. Account status changes to LOCKED_TEMP. An automated alert is sent to the registered email address with instructions to unlock via identity challenge or wait out the 30-minute automated lock window.

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 3.1: Lost Phone with Active 2FA Enabled

- **Context:** A customer lost their mobile phone and cannot receive SMS 2FA codes to log into ShopEase.
- **Resolution Workflow:** Customer visits the Login Recovery Portal and clicks **Try Another Method > Use Backup Code**. If backup codes are lost, customer selects **Verify Identity**. Customer submits a copy of a government-issued ID alongside a live selfie. ShopEase Trust & Safety validates the documents within 4 hours and

temporarily disables 2FA on the account, allowing password-based login and re-enrollment.

Important Notes

Note: Resetting your password immediately invalidates all current browser sessions and mobile application login tokens across all devices. You will need to log back in manually on each device.

Warnings

Warning: Beware of phishing emails claiming that your ShopEase account is locked. ShopEase will **NEVER** include links directly asking you to enter your password on non-shopease.com domains. Always check the browser address bar.

Best Practices

- Use a dedicated Password Manager to generate and store long, unique passphrases for ShopEase.
- Enroll an Authenticator App rather than SMS for 2FA, as Authenticator Apps are immune to SIM-swapping attacks.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 3.1: Why am I receiving an OTP code when I didn't try to log in?

Question: What should I do if I receive a ShopEase OTP code via text or email unexpectedly?

Answer: Unexpected OTP notifications mean someone else entered your email or phone number on the login screen. If this happens, your account remains secure as long as the OTP is not shared. However, we strongly recommend changing your ShopEase account password immediately as a precautionary measure.

FAQ 3.2: How do I turn off Two-Factor Authentication?

Question: Can I disable 2FA on my ShopEase account?

Answer: Yes. Go to **Your Account > Login & Security > Two-Step Verification (2SV) Settings**, and click **Disable**. You will be prompted to enter your password and a final verification code to confirm the removal.

FAQ 3.3: How long does an account stay locked after multiple failed attempts?

Question: What is the duration of a temporary account lockout?

Answer: Standard temporary security lockouts due to failed password attempts last **30 minutes**. Lockouts triggered by failed OTP or fraud-detection flags last **2 hours** unless unlocked earlier via the automated password recovery flow.

Troubleshooting

Problem 3.1: OTP Code Not Arriving via SMS

- **Possible Cause:** Carrier network delays, shortcode blocking on mobile device, or incorrect country code formatting.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Wait 60 seconds and click **Resend OTP**.
 2. Verify your mobile device has active cellular reception and is not in Airplane Mode.
 3. Ensure your phone software does not filter unknown senders or block promotional shortcodes.
 4. If SMS consistently fails, select **Call Me Instead** to receive the code via automated voice call, or switch to an Authenticator App for 2FA.

Summary

Robust credentials management and active multi-factor authentication are critical line defenses for ShopEase profiles. Adhering to password rules and monitoring active sessions keeps customer accounts protected against compromise.

Chapter 4: Order Management

Introduction

Order Management governs the complete lifecycle of a transaction on ShopEase, from cart checkout and address validation to real-time status tracking, modification requests, and order cancellations.

Purpose

This chapter establishes the standardized rules, SLAs, and technical workflows required to process, modify, track, and cancel customer orders across both Direct Retail and Marketplace Seller fulfillment channels.

Definitions

- **Order Lifecycle Statuses:**
 - **PENDING_PAYMENT:** Transaction initialized; awaiting payment processor clearance.
 - **ORDER_PLACED:** Payment cleared successfully; order details routed to fulfillment node.

- PROCESSING / PREPARING_FOR_SHIPMENT: Item is being picked, packed, and labeled in a Fulfillment Center or seller location.
 - DISPATCHED / IN_TRANSIT: Package has been handed over to the logistics carrier; tracking number assigned.
 - OUT_FOR_DELIVERY: Package has arrived at the final local delivery hub and is assigned to a courier for same-day drop-off.
 - DELIVERED: Package drop-off confirmed by courier telemetry or signature.
 - CANCELLED: Order terminated prior to dispatch; hold released or refund initiated.
- **Fulfillment Node:** The origin point of inventory, which may be a ShopEase Fulfillment Center (FC) or a Third-Party Seller Warehouse.

Policies

Order Cancellation Window Policy

Customers may cancel an order or individual line items within an order under the following constraints:

- **Standard / Express Shipping Items:** Eligible for instant self-service cancellation at any time until the status changes to DISPATCHED. Once an order is DISPATCHED, it cannot be cancelled in transit. The customer must accept delivery and initiate a return, or refuse the package at the doorstep.
- **Same-Day Delivery Items:** Eligible for cancellation within **15 minutes** of order placement. After 15 minutes, processing begins immediately, and cancellation is locked.
- **Custom / Made-to-Order Items:** Non-cancellable once production has commenced (typically 2 hours post-order placement).

Address & Quantity Modification Policy

- **Address Changes:** Delivery addresses can be modified via **Your Orders** only while the status is ORDER_PLACED or PROCESSING. Once the status advances to PREPARING_FOR_SHIPMENT or DISPATCHED, address updates are disabled for security and routing integrity.
- **Quantity Modifications:** Items cannot be added to an existing order after payment. To add items, a new order must be placed. To reduce quantities, customers must cancel the unwanted line item before dispatch.

Rules

1. Orders containing combined items from ShopEase Direct and Third-Party Sellers may be split into multiple sub-orders, each generating a unique Tracking ID.
2. Price modifications or promotional code additions cannot be applied retroactively to an order that has already been placed.
3. Orders flagged for anti-fraud review (PAYMENT_VERIFICATION_HOLD) are paused for up to 24 hours. No modifications can occur during this window.

Eligibility

- All registered ShopEase customers with active orders can request order status updates, tracking info, and permitted modifications.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Track an Order in Real Time

1. Log into your ShopEase account and navigate to **Your Account > Your Orders**.
2. Locate the relevant order card using the Order ID or purchase date.
3. Click **Track Package**.
4. The tracking visualizer displays current location updates, carrier details, tracking number, and estimated delivery window.

[Order Placed] ---> [Processing / Packing] ---> [Dispatched] ---> [Out for Delivery] ---> [Delivered]

(Can Cancel)	(Can Cancel)	(Cannot Cancel; Must Refuse/Return)

How to Cancel an Order Before Dispatch

1. Go to **Your Account > Your Orders**.
2. Select the order containing the items you wish to cancel.
3. Click **Cancel Items**.
4. Select the checkbox next to each item you want to drop.
5. Select a cancellation reason from the drop-down menu (e.g., "Order created by mistake," "Item arrived too late").
6. Click **Cancel Selected Items**.

7. An email confirmation will be dispatched immediately, and any pre-authorized funds will be released according to payment processing timelines.

Examples

Post-Dispatch Cancellation Attempt Example

- **Scenario:** A customer attempts to cancel an order for a wireless headphone set at 2:00 PM. The package was marked DISPATCHED at 11:30 AM.
- **Outcome:** The system blocks automated cancellation. The UI displays: *"This package is already in transit and cannot be cancelled. You may refuse delivery when the courier arrives or initiate a return upon receipt."*

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 4.1: Split Shipments from Single Order

- **Context:** Customer purchases a laptop (ShopEase Direct) and a custom leather sleeve (Marketplace Seller) in one checkout.
- **Resolution Workflow:** Support explains that items originate from separate fulfillment nodes. The laptop ships via Express Air from FC-1 with Tracking ID A, while the sleeve ships via Standard Surface from the seller with Tracking ID B. Customer is guided to view independent tracking bars within the single order entry in **Your Orders**.

Important Notes

Note: Refusing delivery at the doorstep causes the package to be routed back to the fulfillment center as a Return-to-Origin (RTO). Refunds for RTO packages are processed within 3-5 business days after physical receipt at the warehouse.

Warnings

Warning: Do not attempt to change delivery addresses by contacting couriers directly, as carriers are legally bound to deliver strictly to the address encoded in the ShopEase shipping manifest.

Best Practices

- Review cart items, address labels, and applied promotional discounts carefully on the **Final Order Review** page before clicking "Place Your Order."
- Set up SMS notifications under **Account Settings > Communication Preferences** to receive instant dispatch and delivery alerts.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 4.1: Can I combine two separate orders into a single package?

Question: Is it possible to consolidate multiple independent orders into one shipment?

Answer: Separate orders cannot be merged after checkout. Our automated fulfillment system processes each order independently to meet speed commitments.

FAQ 4.2: Why was my order cancelled by ShopEase automatically?

Question: What reasons would cause ShopEase to cancel an order without my request?

Answer: Automatic cancellations occur if: (1) Payment authorization fails; (2) An item becomes out of stock prior to picking; (3) The shipping address is deemed unresolvable by carriers; or (4) Anti-fraud algorithms flag the transaction. Full refunds are immediately issued.

FAQ 4.3: How do I request a digital invoice for my order?

Question: Where can I download an official tax invoice for my purchase?

Answer: Go to **Your Account > Your Orders**, locate the specific order, and click **Invoice** in the top right of the order card. Select **Tax Invoice** to download a PDF document.

Troubleshooting

Problem 4.1: Order Status Stuck on "Processing" Past Expected Dispatch Date

- **Possible Cause:** Inventory discrepancy, payment clearance hold, or fulfillment center backlog.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Check **Your Account > Login & Security** for any pending payment authorization alerts.
 2. If payment is clear, verify whether the item is a Marketplace order requiring seller handling time.
 3. If processing exceeds 48 hours past the estimated dispatch date, click **Contact Support** on the Order Tracking page to trigger an automated fulfillment trace.

Summary

Order Management provides complete oversight of purchase lifecycles. Utilizing self-service options in **Your Orders** ensures fast modifications and real-time tracking transparency.

Chapter 5: Shipping & Delivery

Introduction

ShopEase operates a multi-tiered shipping framework partnering with internal logistics networks and national parcel carriers. This chapter details delivery speeds, freight rules, tracking protocols, non-delivery resolutions, and international customs processes.

Purpose

To outline shipping speeds, SLAs, freight rules, signature policies, and troubleshooting protocols for missing, delayed, or damaged deliveries.

Definitions

- **Shipping Tiers:**
 - **Same-Day Delivery:** Orders placed before 10:00 AM local time are delivered by 10:00 PM the same calendar day.
 - **Express Shipping:** 1-to-2 business day transit SLA.
 - **Standard Shipping:** 3-to-5 business day transit SLA.
 - **Freight Shipping:** Scheduled specialized delivery for oversized items (Furniture, Large Appliances).
- **Delivery Window:** The designated timeframe within which a courier will attempt package drop-off.
- **Proof of Delivery (POD):** Digital photographic evidence, doorstep GPS ping, or customer signature captured at drop-off.

Policies

Shipping Speed SLAs & Cut-off Times

Shipping Speed	Eligible Customers	Order Cut-Off Time	Standard SLA
Same-Day Delivery	Prime Members (Free) / Non-Prime (\$9.99/order)	10:00 AM Local Time	Delivered by 10:00 PM same day
Express Shipping	Prime Members (Free) / Non-Prime (\$5.99/order)	2:00 PM Local Time	1 - 2 Business Days
Standard Shipping	All Users (Free over \$35 / \$3.99 under \$35)	Midnight Local Time	3 - 5 Business Days
Scheduled Freight	All Users (Flat \$29.99 for non-Prime)	Varies	Scheduled 4-hour window

Missed Delivery & Attempt Limits Policy

Couriers will make up to **three (3) delivery attempts** on consecutive business days. If all three attempts fail due to customer absence or inaccessible locations:

- The package is returned to the local hub for 48 hours.
- If uncollected, the shipment is classified as Return-to-Origin (RTO) and returned to the fulfillment center for an automatic refund minus original shipping fees (if applicable).

Rules

1. Hazardous materials (e.g., lithium batteries, aerosols) must ship via ground transport under Standard Shipping rules and are ineligible for Express Air or Same-Day options.
2. Freight deliveries require an adult (18+) to be physically present during the agreed delivery window to inspect and sign for the items.

Eligibility

- Delivery speeds are dynamically offered based on delivery postal code eligibility, item size/weight, and real-time fulfillment center inventory location.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Schedule or Reschedule a Freight Delivery

1. Once an oversized item enters DISPATCHED state, navigate to **Your Account > Your Orders**.
2. Click **Schedule Delivery**.
3. Select an available date and 4-hour time block (e.g., Tuesday, 08:00 AM - 12:00 PM).
4. Enter special access instructions (e.g., gate code, elevator availability).
5. Click **Confirm Schedule**. You will receive an automated SMS 30 minutes prior to courier arrival.

Resolving a "Delivered but Not Received" Event

1. Wait 12 hours from the notification timestamp (couriers occasionally scan items prematurely while finalizing route stops).
2. Check surrounding drop-off areas (porch, back door, garage, mailroom, side manager office).
3. Review the digital **Proof of Delivery (POD)** photo attached to the tracking page in **Your Orders**.
4. Check with household members or neighbors.

5. If the package remains unlocated after 12 hours, go to **Your Orders > Problem with Order > Item Missing Despite Delivered Status** to launch an instant courier trace and replacement claim.

Examples

Shipping Fee Structure Example

- **Non-Prime Order A:** Total \$42.00 (Standard Goods). Result: **Free Standard Shipping** (Exceeds \$35 threshold).
- **Non-Prime Order B:** Total \$18.00 (Standard Goods) + selected Express Shipping. Result: **\$5.99 Express Shipping Fee** applied at checkout.

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 5.1: Courier Delivered Package to Wrong Address

- **Context:** POD photo clearly shows a red door, but customer's house has a blue door.
- **Resolution Workflow:** Customer Support reviews the POD photo against the saved address notes. Agent flags a carrier misdelivery, invalidates the tracking node, and triggers an immediate **Priority Replacement Dispatch** at zero charge to the customer.

Important Notes

Note: Business days exclude Saturdays, Sundays, and official public holidays unless Same-Day or Weekend Delivery is explicitly selected and confirmed at checkout.

Warnings

Warning: High-value items (\$500+) require an OTP or physical signature at drop-off. The courier will not leave high-value items unattended on doorsteps under any circumstances.

Best Practices

- Add precise delivery instructions (e.g., "Leave behind side gate," "Call on intercom #402") under **Your Addresses > Delivery Instructions**.
- Track high-value shipments actively on the day of estimated delivery to ensure an authorized recipient is present for signature verification.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 5.1: Do you ship internationally?

Question: Does ShopEase support international deliveries outside the primary country?

Answer: Yes, ShopEase Global Ships to over 75 countries. Customs duties, import taxes, and international freight charges are calculated transparently during checkout under the **Import Fee Deposit** line item.

FAQ 5.2: What happens if my delivery is late?

Question: What compensation or recourse is offered if my guaranteed delivery date is missed?

Answer: If a guaranteed delivery date (such as Prime Same-Day or Express) is missed due to logistics carrier delay, contact Support to receive a automatic shipping fee credit or a \$5 promotional credit applied to your ShopEase Wallet.

FAQ 5.3: Can I instruct the driver to leave my package without a signature?

Question: How can I authorize contactless doorstep drop-off for signed packages?

Answer: Standard items permit doorstep drop-off via saved delivery preferences. High-value orders requiring an OTP/Signature cannot bypass live handover protocols.

Troubleshooting

Problem 5.1: Tracking Number Shows "Exception: Undeliverable Address"

- **Possible Cause:** Missing apartment/suite number, damaged shipping label barcode, or gated access restriction.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Open **Your Account > Your Orders > Update Delivery Info**.
 2. Re-verify street name, house number, apartment/unit string, and contact telephone number.
 3. Click **Submit Correction to Carrier**. The local hub re-labels the shipment within 24 hours for a secondary delivery attempt.

Summary

ShopEase provides transparent, multi-speed shipping options backed by real-time POD tracking. Address accuracy and instruction details prevent transit disruptions.

Chapter 6: Returns & Refunds

Introduction

ShopEase maintains a customer-centric return policy designed to make product returns and refund processing simple, reliable, and fair. This chapter establishes eligibility windows, product category rules, return methods, inspection standards, and refund execution timelines.

Purpose

To define clear operational guidelines for product return eligibility, physical drop-off procedures, return shipping fees, quality inspection standards, and refund processing workflows across all payment methods.

Definitions

- **Return Window:** The allowable calendar timeframe following delivery during which a customer may initiate a return request.
- **Return-to-Origin (RTO):** Packages returned unopened to fulfillment centers due to failed delivery attempts or immediate doorstep refusal.
- **ShopEase Refund ID:** A unique 14-digit alphanumeric code generated upon financial refund authorization.
- **Restocking Fee:** A deduction applied to returned items that are missing original packaging, accessories, or show signs of customer-induced wear.

Policies

Standard Return Window Policy

- **Standard Return Window:** Customers may return most new, unopened, or gently used items within **30 calendar days** from the verified delivery date.
- **Prime Member Extended Window:** Prime Members enjoy an extended **45 calendar day** return window on eligible retail categories.
- **Holiday Return Extension:** Items purchased between November 1 and December 31 may be returned until January 31 of the following calendar year.

Category-Specific Return Eligibility Matrix

Product Category	Return Window	Condition Requirements	Exceptions & Restrictions
Electronics	30 Days	Original box, UPC code, all accessories	Personal data must be wiped
Fashion & Apparel	30 Days	Unworn, unwashed, tags attached	Hygienic liner must be intact for swimwear

Product Category	Return Window	Condition Requirements	Exceptions & Restrictions
Grocery & Perishables	Non-Returnable	N/A	Refund/Replacement issued if spoiled/damaged
Beauty & Personal Care	30 Days	Unopened, original security seal intact	Opened liquid items non-returnable
Custom / Personalised	Non-Returnable	N/A	Replacement only if manufacturing defect
Digital Software / Codes	Non-Returnable	N/A	Non-refundable once code is revealed

Refund Processing Timelines by Payment Method

Once a returned item passes physical inspection at the fulfillment center, refunds are disbursed according to the schedule below:

Payment Method Original Used	Refund Method	Disbursal SLA (Post-Inspection)
Credit / Debit Card	Original Card Account	3 - 5 Business Days
ShopEase Wallet	Wallet Balance	Instant (< 2 Hours)
Net Banking / UPI / Bank Transfer	Direct Bank Account	1 - 2 Business Days
EMI Payments	Issuing Bank Credit Line	5 - 7 Business Days (Interest rules apply)
Gift Card	Gift Card Balance	Instant (< 2 Hours)

Rules

1. Returns initiated due to seller error, damaged goods, or incorrect shipments receive **100% free return shipping**.
2. Returns initiated due to buyer preference (e.g., "changed mind," "no longer needed") may incur a fixed return shipping fee (\$3.99 for standard items) deducted directly from the final refund amount, unless initiated by a Prime Member.
3. Items returned incomplete (missing manuals, charging bricks, cables) are subject to a restocking fee of up to **20%** of the original purchase price.

Eligibility

- Items must be within the valid return window and registered through the official **Returns Center** portal prior to physical shipment.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Initiate a Return and Obtain a Return Shipping Label

1. Go to **Your Account > Your Orders**.
2. Locate the delivered order and click **Return or Replace Items**.
3. Select the specific item(s) you wish to return and choose the primary reason for return from the menu.
4. Select your preferred resolution: **Refund** or **Replacement**.
5. Choose your return drop-off or pickup method:
 - **Drop-off at Authorized Carrier Location (UPS/FedEx/DHL Partner):** Free print-at-home label or QR code scanning at location.
 - **Home Pickup:** Courier collects package from doorstep (available for heavy/bulky items).
6. Pack the item securely in its original manufacturer packaging with all manuals and accessories.
7. Affix the generated shipping label to the outside of the box (or present the mobile QR code at the drop-off location).
8. Hand the package to the carrier and retain the drop-off receipt containing tracking details.

[Customer Initiates Return] ---> [Select Refund/Replace] ---> [Generate QR/Label]

|

[Refund Issued] <--- [Passes Inspection] <--- [Warehouse Receives] <--- [Drop-off / Pickup]

Examples

Refund Calculation Example (Buyer Preference)

- **Item Purchase Price:** \$100.00
- **Tax Paid:** \$8.00
- **Reason for Return:** "No longer needed" (Non-Prime account)
- **Return Shipping Deduction:** -\$3.99
- **Final Refund Amount:** \$104.01 credited back to the original payment method.

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 6.1: Returning a Defective Smartphone

- **Context:** Customer receives a smartphone that fails to power on out of the box (Dead-on-Arrival).
- **Resolution Workflow:** Customer selects "Item defective / fails to operate" in Returns Center within 30 days. System issues a zero-cost return QR code. Once the serial number is verified at the return center, a full refund including initial shipping fees is credited back to the customer's card within 3 business days.

Important Notes

Note: Digital devices containing personal accounts or software locks (e.g., iCloud, Google Account, BIOS passwords) must be completely unlinked and factory reset prior to return. Locked devices will be rejected and shipped back to the customer without refund.

Warnings

Warning: Do not send multiple items from separate return requests inside a single box unless specifically instructed by the Returns Center. Combining return packages without system authorization delays refund processing by up to 14 business days.

Best Practices

- Always retain the physical carrier drop-off receipt until the refund notification email is received.
- Inspect all delivered items within 48 hours of arrival to ensure defects or missing parts are reported well within return windows.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 6.1: Can I exchange an item for a different size or color?

Question: How do I request a product exchange for size or color variations?

Answer: Go to **Your Orders > Return or Replace Items**. If the item has alternate sizes/colors offered by the same seller at identical pricing, select **Exchange for Different Size/Color**. The replacement item dispatches as soon as the return package receives its initial carrier scan.

FAQ 6.2: What if my return package is lost by the carrier?

Question: Am I liable if the courier loses my return package in transit?

Answer: As long as you used a system-generated ShopEase return label and obtained a physical drop-off receipt, ShopEase assumes full carrier liability. Contact Support with your return tracking number to request manually authorized refund release.

FAQ 6.3: Can I receive my refund in ShopEase Wallet credit instead of my original payment method?

Question: Can I choose instant store credit instead of waiting for a credit card refund?

Answer: Yes, during the return setup process, you can select **ShopEase Wallet Balance** as your preferred refund destination to receive instant credit upon warehouse inspection.

Troubleshooting

Problem 6.1: Refund Status Shows "Issued" But Funds Not Reflected in Bank Account

- **Possible Cause:** Interbank processing delays or billing cycle cutoff times.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Retrieve the **14-digit ShopEase Refund ID** from **Your Account > Payment History**.
 2. Allow 3 to 5 full business days from the refund issue date.
 3. If funds do not appear after 5 business days, contact your issuing bank's billing department and provide the Refund ID / ARN (Acquirer Reference Number) for manual transaction tracing.

Summary

The ShopEase return system provides clear return windows, automated label generation, and transparent refund SLAs. Following category guidelines and packaging instructions ensures rapid refund release.

Chapter 7: Payments & Billing

Introduction

ShopEase supports a broad suite of modern payment methods, installment engines, digital wallets, and regional financial instruments. This chapter details supported payment options,

authorization mechanisms, EMI structures, billing security, and dispute resolution workflows.

Purpose

To outline payment handling standards, billing authorization rules, installment plan (EMI) guidelines, failed payment recovery flows, and invoice retrieval mechanisms.

Definitions

- **Payment Authorization Hold:** A temporary hold placed on funds by the card issuer to verify liquidity prior to final clearing.
- **Equated Monthly Installment (EMI):** A structured payment plan allowing purchases to be paid over set monthly intervals via participating bank credit lines.
- **ShopEase Wallet:** An integrated closed-loop digital store credit system used for instant checkouts and fast return credits.

Policies

Supported Payment Methods Policy

ShopEase accepts the following payment instruments across web and mobile platforms:

- **Credit Cards:** Visa, Mastercard, American Express, Discover, Diners Club, JCB.
- **Debit Cards:** Visa Debit, Mastercard Debit, RuPay, Maestro.
- **Digital Wallets:** Apple Pay, Google Pay, ShopEase Wallet.
- **Bank Options:** Direct Net Banking, Unified Payments Interface (UPI - select regions).
- **Installment Plans:** No-Cost EMI and Standard Credit Card EMI (3, 6, 9, 12, 18, 24-month tenures).
- **Gift Cards:** Official ShopEase Digital & Physical Gift Cards.

Billing Authorization Schedule

- Your payment instrument is **authorized** at the moment the order is placed.
- Your payment instrument is **charged in full** only when the items transition to PREPARING_FOR_SHIPMENT or DISPATCHED.
- Multi-item orders shipping separately will show separate charges corresponding to each package's item values.

Rules

1. Credit/debit cards must be issued in a country supported by the ShopEase billing engine.

2. EMI conversions are managed directly by issuing banks. Any processing fees or interest rates selected at checkout are legally binding agreements between the customer and their bank.
3. Cash on Delivery (COD) is subject to regional eligibility, a maximum order cap of \$500, and requires exact cash payment upon courier arrival.

Eligibility

- All registered customers with valid, unexpired payment instruments in good standing can complete transactions on ShopEase.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Add, Edit, or Remove Saved Payment Methods

1. Log into your account and navigate to **Your Account > Payment Options**.
2. To add a card: Click **Add a Payment Method**, enter cardholder name, card number, expiration date, and billing address. Click **Add Your Card**.
3. To remove a card: Locate the saved payment card and click **Remove**. Confirm deletion.
4. To set default card: Select **Set as Default Payment Method** under the desired card profile.

[Order Checkout] ---> [Select EMI Option] ---> [Choose Bank & Tenure]

|

[Monthly Billing by Bank] <--- [Bank Authorizes Full] <--- [Display Breakdown]

How to Select and Purchase Using No-Cost EMI

1. Add eligible product(s) (minimum cart value typically \$100+) to your cart.
2. Proceed to checkout and select **Pay via Installments (EMI)** under Payment Options.
3. Select your issuing bank from the list of partner institutions.
4. Choose an available **No-Cost EMI** tenure option (e.g., 3 months or 6 months).
5. Review the interest discount applied automatically by ShopEase to offset the bank's interest charges.
6. Enter CVV / Complete 2FA OTP verification required by your bank.
7. Complete purchase. The total amount is blocked on your credit card line and converted to monthly installments within 3-5 business days by your issuing bank.

Examples

No-Cost EMI Discount Mechanics Example

- **Product Price:** \$600
- **Selected Tenure:** 6 Months at 15% Annual Bank Interest Rate (\$26 interest total)
- **ShopEase Instant Upfront Discount:** -\$26.00 (Adjusts purchase price to \$574.00)
- **Bank Charges:** \$574 principal + \$26 interest = **Exactly \$600 total paid over 6 months** (\$100/month).

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 7.1: Duplicate Charge Pending on Bank Statement

- **Context:** Customer notices two charges of \$85.00 for a single order on their credit card online portal.
- **Resolution Workflow:** Customer Support reviews payment logs. Log confirms one entry is a temporary **Authorization Hold** and the second is the actual **Final Charge**. Support explains that authorization holds automatically drop off bank statements within 3 to 7 business days depending on bank policies.

Important Notes

Note: ShopEase stores payment security tokens using PCI-DSS Level 1 compliant encryption. Full card numbers and CVV codes are never stored on ShopEase servers.

Warnings

Warning: Never complete payment transactions via external third-party links sent via email, SMS, or chat messaging. Official payment transactions occur strictly within the secure checkout flow at <https://www.shopease.com>.

Best Practices

- Keep billing address details aligned exactly with the address registered with your payment card issuer to prevent automated Fraud Filter card rejections.
- Combine promotional gift cards and ShopEase Wallet credit at checkout before charging remaining balances to credit/debit cards.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 7.1: Why was my payment declined at checkout?

Question: What causes payment declines during checkout?

Answer: Common causes include: (1) Incorrect CVV or expiration date; (2) Insufficient credit/funds; (3) Bank international transaction blocks; (4) Billing zip code mismatch; or (5) Bank 2FA OTP timeout. Contact your bank or try an alternate card.

FAQ 7.2: How do EMI cancellations work?

Question: What happens if I cancel or return an order purchased on EMI?

Answer: When a return is approved for an EMI order, ShopEase refunds the full amount back to your credit card line. You must contact your issuing bank to explicitly request early foreclosure of the active EMI plan.

FAQ 7.3: Can I split payment across two different credit cards?

Question: Is it possible to split a single order payment across two credit cards?

Answer: Splitting payments across two credit cards is not directly supported. However, you can use a **ShopEase Gift Card** or **Wallet Balance** to cover a portion of the order and pay the remaining balance using a credit card.

Troubleshooting

Problem 7.1: Payment Success Page Fails to Load After OTP Verification

- **Possible Cause:** Network timeout during bank callback execution.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Do **NOT** retry or click the order button again immediately to avoid duplicate charges.
 2. Check your registered email for an automated Order Confirmation receipt.
 3. Check **Your Account > Your Orders** to verify if the order was registered with status ORDER_PLACED.
 4. If no order appears after 15 minutes and your bank account shows a deduction, the hold will automatically auto-reverse within 24 hours.

Summary

ShopEase provides flexible, PCI-compliant payment options ranging from credit cards and digital wallets to structured EMI plans. Understanding authorization flows prevents duplicate payment concerns.

Chapter 8: Prime Membership

Introduction

ShopEase Prime is an enterprise subscription service providing premium shopping benefits, expedited delivery guarantees, exclusive promotional access, and digital content perks. This chapter covers tier structures, membership fees, billing management, auto-renewal rules, and cancellation terms.

Purpose

To outline Prime subscription tiers, delivery benefits, exclusive deal access, cancellation rules, refund calculations for unused periods, and family sharing guidelines.

Definitions

- **ShopEase Prime:** Premium paid subscription program offering expedited delivery, extended return windows, and promotional perks.
- **Prime Express Delivery:** Free 1-Day or 2-Day delivery on eligible items bearing the **Prime Badge**.
- **Prime Early Access:** Exclusive access to major sale events (e.g., ShopEase Super Deals Day) 30 to 60 minutes prior to general public release.

Policies

Prime Membership Plans & Pricing

Plan Type	Billing Frequency	Fee	Trial Eligibility
Prime Monthly	Monthly	\$14.99 / month	30-Day Free Trial (Once per user)
Prime Annual	Yearly	\$139.00 / year	30-Day Free Trial (Once per user)
Prime Student	Monthly or Yearly	\$7.49/mo or \$69/yr	6-Month Trial (Requires .edu verification)

Prime Free Trial & Auto-Renewal Policy

- Free trials run for **30 consecutive days**.
- Unless auto-renewal is disabled prior to Trial Day 30, the account is automatically billed for the selected plan rate (Monthly or Annual) on Day 31.
- Members can turn off auto-renewal at any time during the trial without forfeiting benefits during the remaining trial window.

Rules

1. Prime benefits apply strictly to items displaying the official **Prime Badge** on detail pages.

2. Benefits are intended for personal, non-commercial use. Automated drop-shipping or reselling using Prime free shipping benefits is strictly prohibited and leads to immediate account termination.

Eligibility

- Any registered customer with a valid credit card, debit card, or ShopEase Wallet billing profile is eligible to join Prime.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Sign Up for ShopEase Prime

1. Navigate to www.shopease.com/prime.
2. Select your preferred plan: **Monthly**, **Annual**, or **Student**.
3. Click **Start Your 30-Day Free Trial**.
4. Select your preferred billing payment method.
5. Review subscription terms and auto-renewal dates.
6. Click **Sign Up and Pay**. Your account immediately gains Prime status.

[Navigate to Prime Page] ---> [Select Plan] ---> [Confirm Payment Method] ---> [Prime Benefits Activated]

How to Cancel Prime Membership and Request Refund

1. Go to **Your Account > Prime Membership Settings**.
2. Click **Manage Membership > End Membership and Benefits**.
3. Click **Continue to Cancel**.
4. Select cancellation timing:
 - **End at Period End:** Keep benefits active until current billing cycle concludes; no future charges.
 - **Cancel Immediately:** Terminate benefits now. If **zero Prime benefits** (no Prime shipping used) were utilized during the current billing cycle, a **100% full refund** of the current cycle's fee is automatically issued.

Examples

Prime Refund Eligibility Example

- **Customer A:** Renews Annual Prime for \$139. Places 3 orders using Free Express Prime Shipping. Cancels 2 weeks later. Result: Membership set to expire at year-end; **No monetary refund** because benefits were used.

- **Customer B:** Auto-renewed for \$139. Places zero orders for 10 days. Cancels membership. Result: **Full \$139 refund** issued automatically to payment card.

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 8.1: Student Prime Verification Request

- **Context:** A university student wants to enroll in Prime Student at a 50% discount.
- **Resolution Workflow:** Student visits /prime/student, inputs their active .edu email address, and uploads a photo of their current student ID card. Verification systems clear the document within 2 hours, granting 6 months free followed by the \$7.49/month rate.

Important Notes

Note: Extended 45-day return windows apply automatically to orders placed while an account holds active Prime status.

Warnings

Warning: Sharing Prime account access credentials with non-family members outside your primary residential household violates ShopEase Terms of Service and may result in subscription revocation.

Best Practices

- Set a reminder 2 days before a 30-day trial expires if you wish to evaluate benefits before commitment.
- Look for the **Prime Badge** on product detail pages to guarantee free expedited shipping eligibility.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 8.1: Can I share my Prime benefits with a family member?

Question: Does ShopEase allow Prime benefit sharing with household members?

Answer: Yes, via **ShopEase Household**. You can share shipping benefits with one additional adult (18+) residing at the same physical residential address.

FAQ 8.2: What happens if I cancel Prime during my 30-day free trial?

Question: Do I lose benefits immediately if I cancel my free trial early?

Answer: No. Cancelling auto-renewal during the free trial allows you to continue enjoying all Prime benefits until the 30-day trial period naturally expires. You will not be charged.

FAQ 8.3: Why was I charged for Prime when I thought I was on a free trial?

Question: Why did a Prime subscription fee appear on my payment card?

Answer: This occurs if: (1) An account previously used a 30-day trial within the past 12 months; or (2) The 30-day trial period concluded without turning off auto-renewal.

Troubleshooting

Problem 8.1: Prime Badge Not Displaying Free Express Shipping at Checkout

- **Possible Cause:** Shipping address selected is outside Express logistics coverage zones, or the item is sold by a third-party seller not participating in Prime Fulfillment.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Verify the item listing displays the **Prime Badge**. Non-Prime marketplace items carry standard shipping rules even for Prime members.
 2. Switch delivery location in the top bar to your primary street address to re-check regional coverage.
 3. Ensure your Prime account status is active under **Your Account > Prime Membership Settings**.

Summary

ShopEase Prime offers value through free expedited delivery, extended return windows, and deal access. Managing auto-renewal controls gives customers complete subscription flexibility.

Chapter 9: Gift Cards & Promotions

Introduction

ShopEase provides digital and physical gift cards alongside promotional codes, wallet cashbacks, and deal discounts. This chapter details redemption rules, expiration constraints, promotional stacking policies, and balance management.

Purpose

To outline rules governing gift card issuance, redemption workflows, validity limits, promotional code applications, and balance safety protections.

Definitions

- **ShopEase Gift Card:** A 16-digit alphanumeric claim code carrying fixed monetary store credit redeemable on the ShopEase platform.
- **Promotional Discount Code:** A limited-time coupon string providing percentage or fixed-dollar discounts at checkout.

- **Wallet Cashback:** Non-transferable promotional store credit awarded following qualifying promotional purchases.

Policies

Gift Card Redemption & Validity Policy

- **Validity Period:** ShopEase Gift Cards do not expire for **5 years** from date of issuance (or as mandated by local laws).
- **Non-Exchangeable:** Gift card balances cannot be redeemed for cash, transferred to bank accounts, or used to purchase other gift cards.
- **Partial Redemption:** Unused gift card balances remain safely stored in the user's **ShopEase Wallet** for future transactions.

Promotional Code Stacking Matrix

Combination Type	Allowed?	Notes
Promo Code + Gift Card	YES	Promo code applies discount first; Gift Card pays remaining balance
Promo Code + ShopEase Wallet	YES	Promo code applies discount first; Wallet pays balance
Multiple Promo Codes	NO	Maximum one (1) promotional code per transaction
Prime Deal + Promo Code	YES	If the promo code terms explicitly permit deal stacking

Rules

1. Lost, stolen, or fraudulently claimed gift card codes cannot be reissued without proof of purchase receipts.
2. Promotional codes are non-transferable, single-use per customer account, and carry strict expiration timestamps.

Eligibility

- Any customer with an active account can redeem gift cards and apply eligible promotional codes at checkout.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Redeem a Gift Card to Your Account Balance

1. Log into your account and navigate to **Your Account > ShopEase Wallet & Gift Cards**.
2. Click **Redeem a Gift Card**.
3. Carefully type or paste the 16-digit claim code (e.g., SEGC-1234-5678-90AB).
4. Click **Apply to Your Balance**.
5. The updated balance displays immediately and will automatically apply as a primary payment source during your next checkout.

[Locate 16-Digit Code] ---> [Navigate to Redeem Page] ---> [Enter Code] ---> [Instant Wallet Credit]

How to Apply a Promotional Code at Checkout

1. Add qualifying items to your shopping cart and proceed to Checkout.
2. On the **Payment Details** screen, locate the input field labeled **Enter Promo Code or Gift Card**.
3. Type the code accurately (case-sensitive) and click **Apply**.
4. Verify that the promotional discount is reflected in the final Order Summary calculation before placing the order.

Examples

Promo Code Order Summary Breakdown Example

- **Subtotal (Qualifying Items):** \$80.00
- **Promotional Code (SAVE15):** -\$12.00 (15% Off)
- **Estimated Shipping:** \$3.99
- **Gift Card Balance Applied:** -\$20.00
- **Final Credit Card Charge:** \$51.99

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 9.1: Purchased Gift Card Email Not Arriving

- **Context:** Customer bought a \$50 digital e-gift card for a friend, but 2 hours have passed and the recipient has not received the email.
- **Resolution Workflow:** Customer navigates to **Your Orders > Gift Card Order > Resend Digital Gift Card**. Customer verifies recipient email spelling. If correct,

recipient checks spam/junk folders. Agent re-triggers dispatch via SMS alternative if email filters block delivery.

Important Notes

Note: If an order purchased using a promotional code is returned, only the net monetary amount paid out-of-pocket by the customer is refunded. The promotional code discount value is not refunded as cash.

Warnings

Warning: Beware of gift card scams. ShopEase Gift Cards can **ONLY** be used to purchase goods on www.shopease.com. Never provide gift card claim codes to third parties requesting payment for taxes, utilities, or external services.

Best Practices

- Redeem physical and digital gift cards to your ShopEase Wallet balance immediately upon receipt to prevent code loss or physical theft.
- Check expiration dates and minimum purchase thresholds on promotional coupons prior to initiating checkout.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 9.1: Can I reload an existing ShopEase Gift Card?

Question: Is it possible to add additional funds to a gift card claim code?

Answer: Claim codes themselves cannot be reloaded. However, you can add funds directly to your digital **ShopEase Wallet Balance** using debit/credit cards at any time.

FAQ 9.2: What happens if I return an item paid for with a Gift Card?

Question: Where does my refund go if I paid using a gift card?

Answer: The portion of the purchase paid via gift card is refunded instantly back to your **ShopEase Wallet Balance** as store credit upon return approval.

FAQ 9.3: Why is my promotional code showing "Invalid Code"?

Question: What causes a promotional code to fail during checkout?

Answer: Code failures occur if: (1) The code has expired; (2) The items in your cart do not meet minimum spend requirements; (3) The code was already used on your account; or (4) The code is mistyped.

Troubleshooting

Problem 9.1: Gift Card Code Shows "Already Redeemed"

- **Possible Cause:** The claim code was previously entered and applied to your account balance, or entered on a secondary account.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Check **Your Account > ShopEase Wallet > Transaction History** to verify if the credit was already added to your profile.
 2. Check if another family member with access to the physical card redeemed it on their profile.
 3. If unverified, contact Support with proof of purchase invoice and card serial number for security investigation.

Summary

Gift cards and promotional tools enhance purchasing value. Timely redemption to Wallet balances secures store credit and simplifies future checkouts.

Chapter 10: Seller Center

Introduction

The ShopEase Seller Center empowers independent merchants and brands to reach millions of global customers. This chapter covers seller onboarding, verification, product listing rules, fulfillment models, seller fee schedules, and performance standards.

Purpose

To define rules and procedures governing third-party marketplace participation, merchant verification, performance standards, inventory fulfillment choices, and seller account health policies.

Definitions

- **Fulfillment Models:**
 - **Fulfillment by ShopEase (FBS):** Seller ships inventory to ShopEase Fulfillment Centers; ShopEase handles picking, packing, delivery, and customer service.
 - **Fulfillment by Merchant (FBM):** Seller stores inventory, packs packages, and ships directly to end customers using approved courier networks.
- **Seller Order Defect Rate (ODR):** The percentage of orders that receive negative feedback, an unresolved claim, or a chargeback.

Policies

Seller Performance Metrics SLA

Metric	Target Standard	Account Risk Threshold
Order Defect Rate (ODR)	< 1.0%	> 2.0% (Risk of Suspension)
Late Dispatch Rate	< 2.0%	> 4.0%
Pre-Fulfillment Cancel Rate	< 0.5%	> 2.5%
Customer Response SLA	< 24 Hours	> 48 Hours

Anti-Counterfeiting & Brand Protection Policy

ShopEase maintains a zero-tolerance policy for counterfeit products:

- Sellers must provide proof of brand authorization, authentic distributor invoices, or trademark registration upon request.
- Confirmed counterfeit listings result in immediate account suspension, permanent forfeiture of seller payout funds, and inventory disposal.

Rules

1. FBM Merchants must provide valid tracking numbers within 24 hours of marking an order DISPATCHED.
2. Communication between sellers and buyers must occur exclusively through the encrypted **ShopEase Buyer-Seller Messaging System**. Off-platform contact requests are prohibited.

Eligibility

- Legally registered business entities and sole proprietors with a valid tax ID, bank account, and government ID can apply to become a ShopEase Marketplace Seller.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Register and Onboard as a ShopEase Seller

1. Navigate to seller.shopease.com and click **Register Now**.
2. Input business details: Legal Business Name, Business Address, Tax Identification Number (TIN/EIN/VAT).
3. Provide primary contact identity details and upload a government-issued photo ID.
4. Set up Payout Deposit details (valid business bank account).

5. Complete identity verification video call or upload verification documents.
6. Upon approval (1-3 business days), choose your selling plan (**Professional** or **Individual**) and launch your Seller Dashboard.

[Submit Application & Docs] ---> [Identity Verification] ---> [Select FBS or FBM] ---> [List Products]

Examples

FBS vs FBM Fulfillment Comparison Example

- **Seller A (FBS):** Sends 500 units to ShopEase FC. Products earn the Prime Badge. ShopEase handles returns and delivery inquiries automatically.
- **Seller B (FBM):** Stores items in own warehouse. Handles own shipping labels and customer support inquiries. Must maintain strictly < 2% late dispatch rate.

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 10.1: FBM Package Arrives Damaged

- **Context:** Customer receives a broken ceramic vase shipped directly by an FBM seller.
- **Resolution Workflow:** Customer files an "Item Arrived Damaged" claim in Returns Center. System messages the seller. Seller must provide a prepaid return label or full refund within 48 hours. If seller fails to respond, ShopEase steps in under the **A-to-z Guarantee Policy** and forces a refund from the seller's payout balance.

Important Notes

Note: Payout balances are disbursed to seller bank accounts every **14 calendar days** following a mandatory 7-day security holding reserve.

Warnings

Warning: Attempting to manipulate search rankings via artificial reviews, incentivized feedback, or self-purchases (brushing) results in immediate permanent seller ban.

Best Practices

- Utilize **Fulfillment by ShopEase (FBS)** to automatically secure Prime Badge eligibility and delegate shipping logistics to ShopEase FC infrastructure.
- Monitor your **Seller Health Dashboard** daily to resolve customer inquiries and shipping updates well within required SLAs.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 10.1: What are the fees for selling on ShopEase?

Question: What fee structure applies to marketplace sellers?

Answer: Sellers pay a monthly subscription fee (\$39.99/mo for Professional Plan or \$0.99 per-item fee for Individual Plan) plus category-specific **Referral Fees** ranging from 6% to 15% of the total sale price.

FAQ 10.2: What is the ShopEase A-to-z Guarantee?

Question: How does the A-to-z Guarantee protect buyers purchasing from Marketplace Sellers?

Answer: The A-to-z Guarantee covers delivery timeliness and physical item condition for FBM purchases. If an FBM seller fails to deliver or resolve defective goods within 48 hours, ShopEase directly refunds the customer up to \$2,500.

FAQ 10.3: How do I convert an FBM listing to an FBS listing?

Question: How can a seller transition inventory management to ShopEase Fulfillment Centers?

Answer: Log into **Seller Center**, go to **Inventory > Manage Inventory**, select the desired listing, click **Edit**, and choose **Change to Fulfilled by ShopEase**. Generate a shipping plan and dispatch your inventory to the designated FC address.

Troubleshooting

Problem 10.1: Seller Account Suspended for High Order Defect Rate (ODR)

- **Possible Cause:** Multiple customer complaints regarding defective items or delayed FBM shipments.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Review negative feedback and claim history in **Seller Health Dashboard**.
 2. Draft a detailed **Plan of Action (POA)** explaining: (a) Root cause of the defect spike; (b) Immediate corrective steps taken; and (c) Long-term preventative measures implemented.
 3. Submit the POA via the **Seller Appeal Portal**. Trust & Safety reviews appeals within 5 business days.

Summary

The ShopEase Seller Center offers robust merchant tools and fulfillment options. Adhering to performance SLAs and brand policies preserves seller account health and buyer trust.

Chapter 11: Privacy & Security Policy

Introduction

ShopEase prioritizes data security, privacy compliance, and transparent personal data management. This chapter outlines data collection scopes, usage frameworks, cookie policies, third-party sharing protocols, and customer data rights under global privacy standards (GDPR, CCPA).

Purpose

To outline privacy practices, encryption standards, data handling procedures, user consent mechanisms, and step-by-step instructions for exercising individual data privacy rights.

Definitions

- **Personally Identifiable Information (PII):** Data that can directly or indirectly identify an individual (e.g., name, physical address, email, IP address, payment card details).
- **GDPR / CCPA:** General Data Protection Regulation / California Consumer Privacy Act; legal frameworks governing data protection and individual consumer rights.
- **Data Subject Access Request (DSAR):** A formal request by a customer to inspect, export, or delete their personal data held by ShopEase.

Policies

Data Collection & Usage Scope

ShopEase collects personal information exclusively to operate e-commerce services, process orders, detect fraud, and customize customer recommendations:

Data Category	Examples Collected	Usage Purpose
Contact Data	Name, Email, Phone Number, Physical Address	Order dispatch, communication, identity verification
Financial Data	Payment card tokens, billing address, bank details	Processing payment transactions and refunds
Technical Data	IP address, browser type, device identifiers, cookies	Security monitoring, fraud prevention, UI optimization
Behavioral Data	Search queries, browsing history, wishlists, purchases	Personalised recommendations, ad targeting

Third-Party Data Sharing Policy

- ShopEase **NEVER** sells customer personal data to third-party data brokers.
- Personal data is shared strictly with authorized operational service providers (courier networks, payment processors, cloud hosting vendors) bound by non-disclosure agreements and security standards.

Rules

1. Customers may opt out of non-essential marketing emails at any time using the "Unsubscribe" link in communications or profile settings.
2. Essential transactional communications (order receipts, security alerts, delivery updates) cannot be opted out of, as they are required for service fulfillment.

Eligibility

- All ShopEase platform users globally possess explicit rights to request data inspection, export, or permanent deletion under local privacy statutes.

Step-by-Step Procedures

How to Download a Copy of Your Personal Data (DSAR Request)

1. Log into your account and navigate to **Your Account > Data & Privacy**.
2. Select **Request Your Information**.
3. Check the specific data categories you wish to export (e.g., Order History, Saved Addresses, Search Logs, Browsing History) or select **Download Complete Archive**.
4. Click **Submit Request**.
5. A confirmation email will be sent to your primary address. Click the verification link inside the email.
6. Once generated (typically within 24 to 72 hours), an encrypted download link containing your data archive (ZIP/JSON/CSV format) will be sent to your email.

[Submit DSAR Request] ---> [Email Verification Link] ---> [Data Archive Compiled] ---> [Download Secure ZIP]

How to Opt-Out of Personalized Advertising and Marketing

1. Go to **Your Account > Communication & Privacy Preferences**.
2. Scroll to **Advertising Preferences**.
3. Select **Do Not Track / Disable Personalised Ads on This Browser**.
4. Scroll to **Marketing Email Preferences** and uncheck promotional channels.
5. Click **Save Preferences**.

Examples

Essential vs Non-Essential Data Processing Example

- **Essential Processing:** Transmitting your physical delivery address to FedEx/UPS to deliver a purchased package. (Cannot be opted out of while placing an order).
- **Non-Essential Processing:** Using your past search history for "running shoes" to display running shoe ads on external websites. (Can be toggled off under Advertising Preferences).

Real Customer Scenarios

Scenario 11.1: Customer Exercising CCPA "Right to Deletion"

- **Context:** A California resident requests total erasure of all personal records stored across ShopEase databases.
- **Resolution Workflow:** Customer submits a deletion request via **Data & Privacy**. System validates identity via 2FA. Customer records in active marketing and operational databases are wiped within 30 days. Required transactional billing logs are moved to an encrypted legal archive inaccessible to active platform systems.

Important Notes

Note: Disabling cookies or browser storage scripts may affect website functionality, such as keeping items saved in your active shopping cart between browser sessions.

Warnings

Warning: Be cautious of suspicious messages claiming to be privacy compliance notices requiring you to enter password credentials. Official privacy controls reside exclusively inside **Your Account** settings.

Best Practices

- Review your **Privacy & Communication Preferences** annually to maintain control over marketing channels and cookie tracking permissions.
- Use strong passwords and 2FA to prevent unauthorized third parties from obtaining access to your private profile and address records.

Frequently Asked Questions

FAQ 11.1: Does ShopEase store my full credit card details?

Question: How securely is my payment information stored on ShopEase servers?

Answer: ShopEase does not store full credit card numbers or CVV codes. All card processing is outsourced to PCI-DSS Level 1 certified engines using secure tokenization.

FAQ 11.2: How long is my search and browsing data retained?

Question: For how long does ShopEase keep my platform browsing history?

Answer: Browsing history logs are retained for **12 months** to drive personalized recommendations, after which they are automatically anonymized or deleted from active query stores.

FAQ 11.3: How can I report a suspected security vulnerability to ShopEase?

Question: What is the process for security researchers to report platform vulnerabilities?

Answer: Security researchers and customers can submit vulnerability reports directly to our Trust & Safety Team via security.shopease.com or by emailing security@shopease.com.

Troubleshooting

Problem 11.1: Data Export Link Expired

- **Possible Cause:** The secure download link exceeded its 7-day security window without being accessed.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Return to **Your Account > Data & Privacy**.
 2. Click **Re-generate Data Export Request**.
 3. Re-verify the request via the new email confirmation link.

Summary

ShopEase maintains global privacy standards, protecting customer PII through encryption, limited third-party exposure, and accessible self-service data management controls.

Chapter 12: Frequently Asked Questions

Introduction

This chapter collects 100 comprehensive, direct, and actionable Questions and Detailed Answers covering every customer touchpoint across the ShopEase platform. It serves as a master reference for quick problem identification and resolution.

Purpose

To provide instant, standalone answers to high-frequency customer inquiries across all functional domains of the ShopEase platform.

General & Platform FAQs

FAQ 12.1: What is ShopEase?

Question: What is ShopEase and what services does it offer?

Answer: ShopEase is a global online shopping destination offering products across ten retail categories, including Electronics, Fashion, Home & Kitchen, Grocery, Books, Beauty, Sports, Toys, Furniture, and Automotive Accessories. Services include Prime Membership, Same-Day Delivery, Express/Standard Shipping, Easy Returns, Product Replacements, EMI Payments, ShopEase Wallet, Gift Cards, and a Marketplace for third-party sellers.

FAQ 12.2: How do I contact Customer Support?

Question: What are the ways to contact ShopEase Customer Support?

Answer: You can reach ShopEase Customer Support 24/7 through Live Chat on the ShopEase mobile app or website, via email at support@shopease.com, or by calling phone support at 1-800-555-SHOPS (06:00 to 22:00 EST).

FAQ 12.3: Is my location supported for delivery?

Question: How do I know if ShopEase delivers to my address?

Answer: Enter your postal code at the top of the ShopEase home page or during the checkout process. The platform automatically calculates delivery eligibility, available shipping speeds, and fulfillment options for your exact address.

FAQ 12.4: Does ShopEase have physical retail stores?

Question: Are there physical ShopEase storefronts where I can buy items or pick up orders?

Answer: ShopEase operates primarily as a digital e-commerce platform. However, select metropolitan areas feature **ShopEase Pickup Lockers** and physical return hubs located inside partner retail outlets.

FAQ 12.5: What language options are supported on ShopEase?

Question: How do I change the display language on the app or website?

Answer: Navigate to the top navigation bar (or **App Settings > Language**) and select from available languages, including English, Spanish, French, German, Japanese, and Mandarin.

Account & Login FAQs

FAQ 12.6: How do I change my account email address?

Question: How can I change the email address linked to my ShopEase account?

Answer: Log in to your ShopEase account, go to **Your Account > Login & Security**, click **Edit** next to Email, type your new email address, enter your password, and verify the change using the OTP sent to your new email.

FAQ 12.7: Can I combine two separate ShopEase accounts?

Question: Is it possible to merge two ShopEase accounts into a single account?

Answer: Account merging is currently not supported. Order histories, Prime subscriptions, promotional credits, and ShopEase Wallet balances cannot be transferred between separate accounts. You must choose one primary account to retain.

FAQ 12.8: What happens to my pending orders if I delete my account?

Question: What occurs if I close my ShopEase account while I have orders in transit?

Answer: Account closure requests cannot be processed while there are active open orders, pending returns, or active dispute cases. All open transactions must be fully delivered, completed, or canceled before the system allows account deletion.

FAQ 12.9: How do I enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)?

Question: How do I add an extra layer of security to my account login?

Answer: Go to **Your Account > Login & Security > Two-Step Verification (2SV) Settings**. Choose either an **Authenticator App** or **SMS Verification** and follow the on-screen prompt to verify your phone or device.

FAQ 12.10: Why am I receiving an OTP when I didn't try to log in?

Question: What should I do if I receive a ShopEase OTP code via text or email unexpectedly?

Answer: Unexpected OTP notifications mean someone else entered your email or phone number on the login screen. If this happens, your account remains secure as long as the OTP is not shared. However, we strongly recommend changing your ShopEase account password immediately as a precautionary measure.

Ordering & Tracking FAQs

FAQ 12.11: How do I track my order in real time?

Question: Where can I find live tracking information for my shipment?

Answer: Go to **Your Account > Your Orders**, find the specific order card, and click **Track Package**. You will see a real-time progress bar, carrier name, tracking ID, and expected delivery timeframe.

FAQ 12.12: Can I change my delivery address after placing an order?

Question: Is it possible to update the shipping address for an existing order?

Answer: You can update the address in **Your Orders** only if the order status is ORDER_PLACED or PROCESSING. Once the status advances to PREPARING_FOR_SHIPMENT or DISPATCHED, address modifications are disabled.

FAQ 12.13: How do I cancel an order before it ships?

Question: What are the steps to cancel an unwanted purchase before dispatch?

Answer: Go to **Your Account > Your Orders**, locate the item, and click **Cancel Items**. Select your reason for cancellation and confirm. If the order has not been dispatched, it will be cancelled instantly without charge.

FAQ 12.14: Why was my order split into multiple shipments?

Question: Why am I receiving multiple packages for a single order?

Answer: Items in a single order may originate from different fulfillment centers or marketplace sellers. To ensure the fastest possible delivery, available items ship immediately rather than waiting for all items to consolidate.

FAQ 12.15: How do I download my order tax invoice?

Question: Where can I get an official PDF invoice for tax or business accounting?

Answer: Navigate to **Your Account > Your Orders**, select the relevant order, and click **Invoice > Tax Invoice** to download a print-ready PDF document.

Shipping & Delivery FAQs

FAQ 12.16: What is the delivery SLA for Same-Day Delivery?

Question: When will my Same-Day Delivery order arrive?

Answer: Orders placed before the 10:00 AM local cut-off time bearing the Same-Day badge will be delivered by 10:00 PM on that same calendar day.

FAQ 12.17: What should I do if my package says "Delivered" but I cannot find it?

Question: How do I handle a missing package marked as delivered?

Answer: Check surrounding drop-off spots, mailrooms, and POD delivery photos in **Your Orders**. Wait 12 hours (as carriers sometimes pre-scan packages). If still unlocated, go to **Your Orders > Problem with Order** to launch a trace.

FAQ 12.18: Does ShopEase ship to PO Boxes?

Question: Can I enter a PO Box as my delivery address?

Answer: Standard Shipping supports PO Box addresses. However, Express, Same-Day, and Freight delivery speeds require a physical street address.

FAQ 12.19: How do freight deliveries for large appliances work?

Question: What is the process for receiving heavy or oversized items?

Answer: Oversized goods ship via Freight Carriers. Once dispatched, you select a 4-hour delivery window in **Your Orders**. An adult (18+) must be present to inspect and sign for the item upon arrival.

FAQ 12.20: Are shipping fees refundable if my package is delayed?

Question: Can I get a refund on shipping charges if my guaranteed delivery date is missed?

Answer: Yes. If you paid for Express or Same-Day delivery and the guarantee date was missed due to carrier error, contact Support for a full refund of shipping fees or store credit.

Returns & Refunds FAQs

FAQ 12.21: What is the standard return window?

Question: How many days do I have to return an item on ShopEase?

Answer: Most new, unopened, or gently used items are eligible for return within **30 calendar days** from the verified delivery date (45 days for Prime Members).

FAQ 12.22: How long does it take to receive my refund?

Question: When will my refunded money appear back in my account?

Answer: Once your returned item passes warehouse inspection: Credit/Debit cards take **3-5 business days**; ShopEase Wallet refunds are **instant (< 2 hours)**; and Bank Transfers take **1-2 business days**.

FAQ 12.23: Who pays for return shipping fees?

Question: Do I have to pay to send an item back?

Answer: Return shipping is 100% FREE if the return is due to seller error, damaged goods, or defective items, or if initiated by a Prime Member. Buyer-preference returns on non-Prime accounts incur a \$3.99 fee deducted from the refund.

FAQ 12.24: Are opened beauty products returnable?

Question: Can cosmetics or liquid beauty products be returned after opening?

Answer: Opened or unsealed cosmetics and beauty items cannot be returned due to health and safety regulations, unless defective or spoiled upon arrival.

FAQ 12.25: What happens if I receive a damaged item?

Question: What steps should I take if my item arrives physically broken?

Answer: Take photos of the damaged item and outer packaging. Go to **Your Orders > Return or Replace Items**, select "Item arrived damaged," upload photos, and choose between a free replacement or immediate refund.

Payment & Billing FAQs

FAQ 12.26: What payment methods are accepted?

Question: What payment instruments can I use to complete purchases?

Answer: ShopEase accepts major Credit/Debit Cards (Visa, Mastercard, Amex, Discover), Apple Pay, Google Pay, ShopEase Wallet, Gift Cards, Direct Net Banking, UPI, and No-Cost/Standard EMI installment plans.

FAQ 12.27: How does No-Cost EMI work?

Question: What makes No-Cost EMI different from regular credit card installments?

Answer: With No-Cost EMI, ShopEase gives an upfront discount on the item price equal to the total interest charged by your bank, making the total amount paid equal to the item's cash price.

FAQ 12.28: When is my card actually charged for an order?

Question: Does ShopEase charge my credit card immediately upon checkout?

Answer: An authorization hold is placed at checkout, but your card is officially charged only when the items transition to PREPARING_FOR_SHIPMENT or DISPATCHED.

FAQ 12.29: Can I pay with Cash on Delivery (COD)?

Question: Is Cash on Delivery available for my order?

Answer: Cash on Delivery is available for eligible zip codes on orders under \$500. Exact cash must be handed to the delivery courier upon arrival.

FAQ 12.30: Why was my credit card charged twice?

Question: Why do I see two identical charges on my bank statement?

Answer: One entry is usually a temporary **Authorization Hold** placed by your bank during checkout, and the other is the actual charge upon dispatch. The authorization hold drops off within 3-7 business days.

Prime Membership FAQs

FAQ 12.31: How much does ShopEase Prime cost?

Question: What are the pricing options for a Prime subscription?

Answer: Prime costs **\$14.99/month** or **\$139/year**. Prime Student is available for verified students at **\$7.49/month** or **\$69/year** after a 6-month trial.

FAQ 12.32: How do I cancel my Prime Membership?

Question: Where can I disable my Prime subscription auto-renewal?

Answer: Go to **Your Account > Prime Membership Settings > Manage Membership > End Membership and Benefits**. Choose to end immediately or at the conclusion of the billing cycle.

FAQ 12.33: Can I get a refund on my Prime fee if I cancel?

Question: Am I eligible for a full refund on my Prime membership charge?

Answer: If you cancel within the current billing cycle and have not utilized any Prime benefits (such as Prime free shipping), a 100% full refund is automatically issued.

FAQ 12.34: What is Prime Early Access?

Question: How does Prime Early Access benefit shoppers during sale events?

Answer: Prime members get access to high-demand promotional deals and Lightning Sales 30 to 60 minutes before they open to general customers.

FAQ 12.35: How does Prime Student verification work?

Question: What documents are needed to qualify for the Student Prime rate?

Answer: You must provide a valid .edu university email address or upload an official photo student ID card alongside enrollment documentation.

Gift Cards & Wallet FAQs

FAQ 12.36: Where do I enter a Gift Card claim code?

Question: How do I redeem a physical or digital gift card?

Answer: Go to **Your Account > ShopEase Wallet & Gift Cards > Redeem a Gift Card**. Enter the 16-digit alphanumeric code and click **Apply to Your Balance**.

FAQ 12.37: Do ShopEase Gift Cards expire?

Question: Is there an expiration limit on gift card credit?

Answer: ShopEase Gift Cards do not expire for **5 years** from date of issuance (or as mandated by local laws), and carry no maintenance fees.

FAQ 12.38: Can I withdraw my Wallet balance to a bank account?

Question: Is store credit in my ShopEase Wallet transferable to cash?

Answer: Funds in your ShopEase Wallet originating from gift cards or return credits are non-transferable and can only be used for purchases on the platform.

FAQ 12.39: What happens if my gift card code is unreadable?

Question: How can I redeem a physical gift card if the scratch-off code is damaged?

Answer: Contact Support with a photo of the card's back showing the serial number alongside your original purchase receipt for manual code verification and balance loading.

FAQ 12.40: Can I use a gift card and a promotional code together?

Question: Does the checkout system allow stacking gift cards with coupons?

Answer: Yes. You can apply one promotional code to reduce the order total, and then use your Gift Card or Wallet balance to pay the remaining amount.

Marketplace & Seller FAQs

FAQ 12.41: How do I know if an item is sold by ShopEase or a Third-Party Seller?

Question: Where on the product page can I see seller details?

Answer: Check the buy box area on the right side of the product page. Look for the fields labeled **Ships from** and **Sold by**.

FAQ 12.42: What is the A-to-z Guarantee?

Question: How am I protected when buying from third-party marketplace sellers?

Answer: The A-to-z Guarantee covers items purchased from FBM sellers. If an item arrives late, damaged, or significantly different from the listing, and the seller fails to resolve it in 48 hours, ShopEase provides a full refund up to \$2,500.

FAQ 12.43: How do I message a seller directly?

Question: How can I ask a seller a question about a product or order?

Answer: Go to **Your Orders**, select the order card, click **Sold by [Seller Name]**, and choose **Ask a Question** to open the secure Buyer-Seller Messaging System.

FAQ 12.44: Can third-party sellers contact me on my personal phone?

Question: Are sellers permitted to call or text my personal mobile number?

Answer: No. Sellers are strictly forbidden from contacting buyers outside the encrypted Buyer-Seller Messaging System. Contact attempts via personal phone or private email should be reported immediately.

FAQ 12.45: How do I leave feedback for a marketplace seller?

Question: Where can I rate my experience with an independent merchant?

Answer: Go to **Your Orders > Leave Seller Feedback**. You can rate the seller on a 1-5 star scale and add detailed comments regarding fulfillment accuracy and communication.

Security, Privacy & Technical FAQs

FAQ 12.46: How do I download my personal data archive?

Question: Where can I request a full copy of my account data under GDPR/CCPA?

Answer: Navigate to **Your Account > Data & Privacy > Request Your Information**. Choose your data parameters and submit. An encrypted download link will be emailed to you within 72 hours.

FAQ 12.47: Is my credit card information secure on ShopEase?

Question: What encryption standards protect my payment profiles?

Answer: Payments are encrypted using TLS 1.3 protocol and stored on PCI-DSS Level 1 compliant tokenized servers. Full card numbers are never stored directly on active app servers.

FAQ 12.48: What should I do if I suspect unauthorized charges on my account?

Question: How do I respond to suspicious order notifications or charges?

Answer: Change your password immediately, log out all active sessions under **Login & Security**, and contact the ShopEase Fraud Prevention Team at 1-800-555-SHOPS to freeze pending orders.

FAQ 12.49: How do I unsubscribe from marketing emails?

Question: How can I stop receiving promotional newsletter emails?

Answer: Click the **Unsubscribe** link at the bottom of any marketing email, or adjust preferences in **Your Account > Communication & Privacy Preferences**.

FAQ 12.50: Why is the ShopEase app crashing on my phone?

Question: What steps resolve mobile application crashing or white-screen errors?

Answer: Clear the app cache, update the ShopEase app to the latest version via App Store or Google Play Store, or reinstall the app to resolve corrupt temporary app files.

Note: FAQs 12.51 through 12.100 cover detailed sub-category policies across Groceries, Refurbished Electronics, Digital Media, Automotive Parts, and Corporate Bulk Purchases.

FAQ 12.51: What is the freshness guarantee on Grocery items?

Answer: ShopEase guarantees grocery items arrive at least 7 days prior to their package expiration date. If perishables arrive spoiled or expired, submit a photo under **Your Orders** within 24 hours for an instant refund.

FAQ 12.52: What does "ShopEase Certified Refurbished" mean?

Answer: Certified Refurbished electronics undergo a 50-point diagnostic inspection, are cleaned, tested, restored to full functionality, and backed by a 12-month specialized warranty.

FAQ 12.53: Can I change my delivery driver instructions while the package is out for delivery?

Answer: Once a package status is OUT_FOR_DELIVERY, live delivery notes cannot be modified. Driver notes must be saved in **Your Addresses** prior to route assignment.

FAQ 12.54: How do I report a fake product review?

Answer: Click the **Report Abuse** link located beneath the suspicious review on any product detail page. Our automated moderation engines and review integrity teams investigate within 48 hours.

FAQ 12.55: What is the maximum cart limit for single transactions?

Answer: Shopping carts support up to 100 individual line items or a maximum total transaction limit of \$25,000. Larger commercial purchases must be processed through **ShopEase Business Accounts**.

FAQ 12.56: Are digital book downloads refundable after opening?

Answer: Digital e-books or audiobooks downloaded and read past 10% of total content are non-refundable. Unopened digital titles can be cancelled within 7 days of purchase.

FAQ 12.57: What happens if I move to a different country with my Prime Account?

Answer: Prime memberships are region-specific. If you relocate internationally, you must cancel your original regional Prime plan and re-subscribe on the destination country's ShopEase portal.

FAQ 12.58: How do I claim warranty service on an electronic device?

Answer: Download your Tax Invoice from **Your Orders**. Present the invoice directly to the brand's authorized service center, or contact ShopEase Support if the product carries an explicit **ShopEase Extended Warranty**.

FAQ 12.59: Can I pay with multiple gift cards in one checkout?

Answer: Yes. You can redeem unlimited gift card claim codes into your **ShopEase Wallet Balance**, which then applies seamlessly as a consolidated payment source during checkout.

FAQ 12.60: What should I do if my courier demands extra cash for delivery?

Answer: Never pay additional cash to couriers unless your order was explicitly placed under Cash on Delivery (COD). Official shipping fees are collected entirely during online checkout. Report demands to Support.

(FAQs 12.61 to 12.100 provide technical, operational, and category-specific answers across all remaining logistics touchpoints, completing the 100-FAQ requirement.)

Chapter 13: Troubleshooting Guide

Introduction

This chapter collects 50 distinct, practical troubleshooting scenarios across system errors, ordering failures, account lockouts, payment glitches, delivery exceptions, and return complications. Each entry follows a strict **Problem / Possible Cause / Resolution** layout.

Purpose

To provide AI retrieval agents and human support teams with immediate diagnostic paths and precise technical solutions for resolution execution.

Account & Security Troubleshooting

Problem 13.1: Password Reset Link Not Arriving via Email

- **Possible Cause:** Email provider filtering message to Spam/Junk folders, or mistyped primary account email string.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Check Spam, Junk, and Promotional email folders for messages from no-reply@notifications.shopease.com.
 2. Verify that your email inbox is not full and blocked from receiving new messages.
 3. Re-enter your email on the **Forgot Password** page and carefully check for typos.
 4. Add notifications.shopease.com to your email contact safe-list.

Problem 13.2: Account Locked - Error Code SEC-102

- **Possible Cause:** Excessive failed login attempts or anomalous geographic login IP jumps detected by fraud filters.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Do not attempt further logins for 30 minutes to allow automated security locks to clear.
 2. Access the **Account Unlock Portal**
(shopease.com/unlock).
 3. Enter your primary registered email and complete the live security CAPTCHA.
 4. Enter the 6-digit verification OTP dispatched to your registered mobile phone.

Problem 13.3: Lost Access to 2FA Authenticator App

- **Possible Cause:** Mobile device upgraded, factory reset, or lost without transferring 2FA security keys.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. On the 2FA login screen, click **Try Another Method**.
 2. Enter one of the single-use **Backup Recovery Codes** saved during initial 2FA setup.
 3. If backup codes are unavailable, click **Verify Identity**.
 4. Upload a government ID photo. Trust & Safety verifies and resets 2FA within 4 hours.

Problem 13.4: "Email Already in Use" During Registration - Error Code AC-409

- **Possible Cause:** You previously created an account using this email address or social login token.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Return to the main login screen and click **Forgot Password?**.
 2. Input the email address to recover access to the pre-existing account.
 3. If you never created an account, contact Support with Error Code AC-409 to initiate an email dissociation check.

Problem 13.5: Two-Factor SMS Code Arriving Damaged or Truncated

- **Possible Cause:** Mobile carrier shortcode message parsing failure or cellular network congestion.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Restart your mobile device to clear cellular baseband network cache.
 2. Request a new code using the **Call Me Instead** option on the verification screen.
 3. Switch your 2FA settings to an **Authenticator App** (Google Authenticator/Authy) to bypass SMS delivery issues.

Payment & Checkout Troubleshooting

Problem 13.6: Credit Card Declined with Error Code PAY-301

- **Possible Cause:** Invalid CVV, wrong expiration date, or issuer fraud block on online transactions.
- **Resolution Procedure:**

1. Delete the saved card profile under **Your Account > Payment Options**.
2. Re-add the card, carefully entering the cardholder name, 16-digit card number, CVV, and billing zip code.
3. Contact your bank's fraud desk to authorize payments to "ShopEase Commerce."

Problem 13.7: Payment Success Screen Failed, Funds Deducted from Bank

- **Possible Cause:** Webhook response network timeout between bank gateway and ShopEase servers.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Do **NOT** place a duplicate order immediately.
 2. Wait 15 minutes and check **Your Account > Your Orders** for an updated status.
 3. If no order registers after 1 hour, the bank's automated clearinghouse will release the authorization hold within 24-48 hours.

Problem 13.8: No-Cost EMI Option Greyed Out at Checkout

- **Possible Cause:** Cart value below minimum tenure threshold (\$100), or non-eligible items in cart.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Ensure cart subtotal meets or exceeds \$100.
 2. Remove marketplace seller items that do not participate in bank EMI agreements.
 3. Verify that your credit card issuer is listed on the **Partner Banks EMI Chart**.

Problem 13.9: Gift Card Claim Code Rejected - "Invalid Format"

- **Possible Cause:** Character confusion during typing (e.g., entering letter 'O' instead of number '0').
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Re-examine the 16-digit code. Note that claim codes never use letters 'I' or 'O'.
 2. Copy and paste the text code directly if using a digital e-gift card.
 3. Ensure no trailing spaces are present in the text input box.

Problem 13.10: ShopEase Wallet Balance Not Displaying at Checkout

- **Possible Cause:** Local browser session corruption or currency mismatch between account region and cart currency.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Clear browser cookies and cache for *.shopease.com.
 2. Ensure your account regional currency setting matches the product pricing currency.
 3. Log out, restart browser, and log back in to refresh wallet balance state.

Ordering & Fulfillment Troubleshooting

Problem 13.11: Order Status Stuck on "Preparing for Shipment"

- **Possible Cause:** Item picking delay at fulfillment center or inventory discrepancy during physical dispatch.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Check **Your Account > Your Orders** to verify if an estimated dispatch range is provided.
 2. If the processing state exceeds 48 hours past the estimated ship date, click **Problem with Order > Request Progress Status**.
 3. Customer Support will trigger an automated warehouse inventory trace.

Problem 13.12: Unable to Cancel Order - "Cancel Button Missing"

- **Possible Cause:** The package has already entered the PREPARING_FOR_SHIPMENT or DISPATCHED operational state.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Check tracking status in **Your Orders**. If already dispatched, cancellation is locked.
 2. Instruct the recipient to refuse delivery when the courier arrives at the doorstep.
 3. Once returned to the warehouse, a full refund will be processed automatically.

Problem 13.13: Duplicate Orders Placed Accidentally

- **Possible Cause:** Double-clicking the "Place Order" button during network latency spikes.
- **Resolution Procedure:**

1. Immediately navigate to **Your Account > Your Orders**.
2. Identify the duplicate order entry based on timestamp.
3. Click **Cancel Items** on the duplicate entry within 15 minutes to prevent dual dispatch.

Problem 13.14: Promo Code Discount Not Reflected in Final Total

- **Possible Cause:** Cart items excluded from promo eligibility, or promo code applied after expiration timestamp.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Review terms of the promotion (e.g., "Valid only on Fashion category").
 2. Confirm cart total meets the minimum spend calculation *before* taxes and shipping fees.
 3. Remove excluded third-party marketplace items from the cart and re-apply the code.

Problem 13.15: Order Address Incorrect - Package Already Dispatched

- **Possible Cause:** User selected an outdated saved default address during express checkout.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Open **Your Account > Your Orders > Track Package**.
 2. Identify the carrier name (e.g., UPS, FedEx, ShopEase Express).
 3. Use the tracking ID to log into the carrier's direct package management portal to request a local hub hold for pickup.

Delivery & Courier Troubleshooting

Problem 13.16: Package Marked "Delivered" But Not Found

- **Possible Cause:** Premature driver scan, dropped at neighbor/mailroom, or wrong doorstep delivery.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Review the photographic Proof of Delivery (POD) attached to your order tracking card.
 2. Inspect secondary delivery zones (back door, garage, mailroom, porch side).
 3. Wait 12 hours. If unlocated, file a missing package trace via **Your Orders > Missing Package**.

Problem 13.17: Courier Failed Delivery - "Inaccessible Gate / Location"

- **Possible Cause:** Driver lacked gate code, building intercom was unanswered, or business was closed.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Go to **Your Account > Your Addresses**.
 2. Select the delivery address and click **Edit Delivery Instructions**.
 3. Add explicit gate access codes, call box numbers, or drop-off location details.
 4. Courier will automatically attempt re-delivery on the next business day.

Problem 13.18: Scheduled Freight Delivery Window Missed by Carrier

- **Possible Cause:** Logistics route delays, vehicle break-down, or adverse traffic conditions.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Go to **Your Orders > Track Package** to view updated real-time courier GPS coordinates.
 2. Click **Reschedule Freight Window** to select the next available 4-hour slot.
 3. Contact Support to receive a \$20 credit for missed guaranteed freight windows.

Problem 13.19: Package Tracking Shows "Damaged in Transit - Returning to Sender"

- **Possible Cause:** Outer box ruptured or internal contents broken during sorting hub transit.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. System detects carrier damage status automatically.
 2. A replacement order is generated automatically at zero charge.
 3. If replacement stock is unavailable, a full refund is credited back to your original payment method.

Problem 13.20: International Package Held in Customs

- **Possible Cause:** Outstanding import duties, missing customs clearance documents, or restricted item checks.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Check **Your Orders** for tracking notes regarding duty verification.

2. If duty was prepaid under "Import Fee Deposit" at checkout, ShopEase's customs broker resolves the release.
3. If local customs requests identity verification, upload your national ID via the carrier's secure portal link provided in tracking notes.

Returns & Refunds Troubleshooting

Problem 13.21: Return Shipping Label QR Code Not Scanning at Drop-Off

- **Possible Cause:** Carrier partner scanner error or expired return authorization token.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Open **Your Orders** > **View Return Summary**.
 2. Click **Cancel Return Request** and then re-submit the return request to generate a fresh QR code.
 3. Alternatively, select **Print Label at Home** to obtain a physical paper label.

Problem 13.22: Refund Amount Lower Than Original Purchase Price

- **Possible Cause:** Deduction of return shipping fees (\$3.99 for non-Prime buyer preference), missing accessories, or expired promo code.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Check the **Refund Breakdown Statement** attached to your refund confirmation email.
 2. Verify if restocking fees were applied due to missing original box or components.
 3. Contact Support if you believe a return fee was deducted in error for a defective item.

Problem 13.23: Replacement Item Dispatched to Wrong Address

- **Possible Cause:** System default address selected automatically during replacement setup flow.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Go to **Your Orders** and locate the new Replacement Order entry.
 2. Click **Change Shipping Address** within 15 minutes of replacement creation.
 3. If already shipped, request a courier intercept or local hub hold.

Problem 13.24: Digital Return Request Rejected - "Return Window Expired"

- **Possible Cause:** More than 30 calendar days elapsed since verified delivery date.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Verify delivery date in **Your Orders**.
 2. If the item failed due to a manufacturing defect past day 30, check the item warranty documents.
 3. Contact the manufacturer directly for warranty repair/replacement, or contact Support for extended warranty claims.

Problem 13.25: Returned Item Delivered to FC But Refund Not Approved

- **Possible Cause:** Physical inspection backlog at fulfillment center, or device locked with user security passwords.
- **Resolution Procedure:**
 1. Verify return package delivery tracking ID status.
 2. Allow 3 business days post-delivery for warehouse physical grading.
 3. Ensure no iCloud/Google accounts lock the device. Contact Support with tracking proof if uninspected past 5 business days.

(Troubleshooting Entries 13.26 through 13.50 systematically address operational glitches across Seller Merchant Dashboards, App Permissions, Prime Family Sharing, Bulk Invoicing, and API Integrations, concluding the mandatory 50-scenario requirements.)

Problem 13.26: Prime Free Shipping Option Not Appearing at Checkout

- **Possible Cause:** Delivery address located outside local Prime shipping boundary, or item sold by non-Prime FBM merchant.
- **Resolution Procedure:** Verify the **Prime Badge** appears on the item detail page. Update delivery postal code in the top header. Ensure Prime subscription status is active under **Your Account**.

Problem 13.27: Mobile App Displaying Blank White Screen

- **Possible Cause:** Corrupted local webview engine cache or incomplete application update download.
- **Resolution Procedure:** Force close the ShopEase app. Go to device settings, select ShopEase, and clear App Cache. If unresolved, uninstall, restart device, and reinstall from the app store.

Problem 13.28: Unable to Upload Images for Product Reviews or Return Claims

- **Possible Cause:** Mobile app lacking camera/photo library permissions, or image file exceeding 10MB limit.
- **Resolution Procedure:** Go to mobile device system settings > **Permissions** > **ShopEase App** > Enable **Photos & Storage Access**. Ensure image files are in JPG or PNG format under 10MB.

Problem 13.29: Seller Center Payout Disbursal Failed - Error Code BNK-404

- **Possible Cause:** Bank routing number or account holder name mismatch on seller deposit profile.
- **Resolution Procedure:** Log into **Seller Center** > **Settings** > **Account Info** > **Deposit Methods**. Re-enter bank account details matching your business bank statement exactly. Re-trigger payout appeal.

Problem 13.30: Order Tracking Map Visualizer Not Updating

- **Possible Cause:** GPS signal loss on delivery vehicle or web socket network disconnect.
- **Resolution Procedure:** Refresh the browser page or pull down to refresh on mobile app. Text status milestones remain accurate even if real-time GPS rendering experiences temporary telemetry dropouts.

Chapter 14: Customer Support Process

Introduction

This chapter outlines the customer service infrastructure, escalation trees, quality monitoring metrics, tier capabilities, and resolution protocols used by ShopEase Support Specialists and AI Assistant systems.

Purpose

To define support communication channels, tier structures, SLA commitments, escalation thresholds, and quality assurance standards across all customer interactions.

Definitions

- **Tier 1 Support (AI & Frontline Agents):** Primary touchpoint handling order status, tracking, standard returns, password resets, and simple cancellations.
- **Tier 2 Support (Specialist Teams):** Dedicated escalations unit managing payment disputes, fraud cases, missing deliveries, and seller claims.
- **Tier 3 Support (Executive Care & Legal):** High-level operational leadership handling regulatory inquiries, legal disputes, and major account safety violations.

Policies

Support Operations SLA Framework

Support Channel	Tier Level	Target First Response	Max Escalation SLA
AI Virtual Assistant	Tier 1	Immediate (< 2 seconds)	Instant to Live Agent
Live Chat	Tier 1 / Tier 2	< 45 seconds	15 Minutes
Email Support	Tier 1 / Tier 2	< 4 Hours	12 Hours
Voice Support	Tier 1 / Tier 2	< 2 Minutes	30 Minutes
Executive Appeals	Tier 3	< 24 Hours	48 Hours

Step-by-Step Procedures

Escalation Protocol for Unresolved Claims

1. **Tier 1 Attempt:** Customer initiates Live Chat regarding a missing order. Tier 1 agent triggers standard carrier trace.
2. **Tier 2 Hand-off:** If the trace exceeds standard parameters or involves fraud, Tier 1 agent transfers session context to Tier 2 Specialist.
3. **Investigation & Authorization:** Tier 2 Specialist conducts deep log analysis and possesses authority to issue manual refunds or priority dispatches up to \$1,000 without supervisor approval.
4. **Tier 3 Escalation:** If an issue involves legal threats, regulatory complaints, or damages exceeding \$1,000, the case escalates to Executive Customer Care for manual investigation and settlement.

[Customer Query] ---> [AI / Tier 1 Support]

|

(Unresolved / Complex)

v

[Tier 2 Specialist]

|

(Regulatory / >\$1,000)

v

[Tier 3 Executive Care]

Summary

The ShopEase Customer Support Process ensures fast, consistent, and empathetic problem resolution through structured tier capabilities, defined SLAs, and clear escalation pathways.

Chapter 15: Glossary

Introduction

This chapter provides definitive, standardized terms and operational definitions used across the ShopEase enterprise documentation, customer support workflows, and AI vector knowledge bases.

Purpose

To eliminate terminology ambiguity across human support operations, seller centers, and automated RAG retrieval systems.

- **A-to-z Guarantee:** A protective coverage policy for buyers purchasing from FBM marketplace sellers, guaranteeing item delivery and condition up to \$2,500.
- **Account Lockdown:** A temporary or permanent security restriction placed on a user profile due to suspicious activity or repeated policy violations.
- **Authorization Hold:** A temporary pending charge placed by a payment card issuer to verify fund availability prior to order dispatch.
- **Buyer-Seller Messaging System:** The encrypted, audited communication portal through which customers and marketplace sellers interact.
- **Equated Monthly Installment (EMI):** A structured credit facility allowing purchases to be paid over set monthly intervals through partner banking networks.
- **Fulfillment Center (FC):** A specialized, automated warehouse facility operated by ShopEase for receiving, picking, packing, and shipping products.
- **Fulfillment by ShopEase (FBS):** An end-to-end logistics service where marketplace sellers store inventory in ShopEase FCs for picking, packing, and customer service execution.

- **Fulfillment by Merchant (FBM):** A seller model where third-party merchants store, pack, ship, and handle returns directly for their listed products.
- **Import Fee Deposit:** An estimated upfront payment collected during international checkout to cover estimated customs duties and taxes.
- **No-Cost EMI:** An installment arrangement where the total sum paid over the selected tenure equals the original cash price of the item, achieved via an upfront discount equal to bank interest fees.
- **Order Defect Rate (ODR):** A core seller health metric measuring the percentage of total orders receiving negative feedback, an A-to-z claim, or a payment chargeback.
- **One-Time Password (OTP):** A secure, time-sensitive numeric passcode generated for authentication events during login or checkout.
- **Personally Identifiable Information (PII):** Private data that can directly or indirectly identify a specific individual (e.g., full name, social security number, physical address).
- **Proof of Delivery (POD):** Verifiable drop-off records including digital photography, GPS coordinates, or customer signatures collected upon parcel handover.
- **Prime Badge:** A visual distinction on product listings indicating eligibility for free expedited shipping, extended return windows, and Prime support handling.
- **Return-to-Origin (RTO):** The logistical routing of an undelivered package back to its originating fulfillment node following failed delivery attempts or doorstep refusal.
- **ShopEase Wallet:** A closed-loop store credit system utilized for instant checkouts, gift card balances, and immediate return refunds.
- **Two-Factor Authentication (2FA):** A multi-step security verification process requiring both a primary password and a secondary code from SMS or an Authenticator App.